



Data Science and Business Analytics

Data Science Case Studies
Lecture 7

Moscow
2025

Forecast Accuracy Measurement. Store Clusterization

Alexey Romanenko

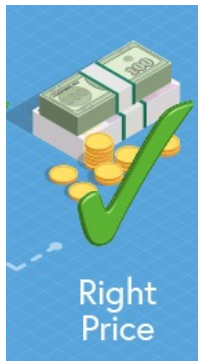
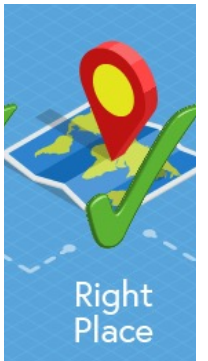
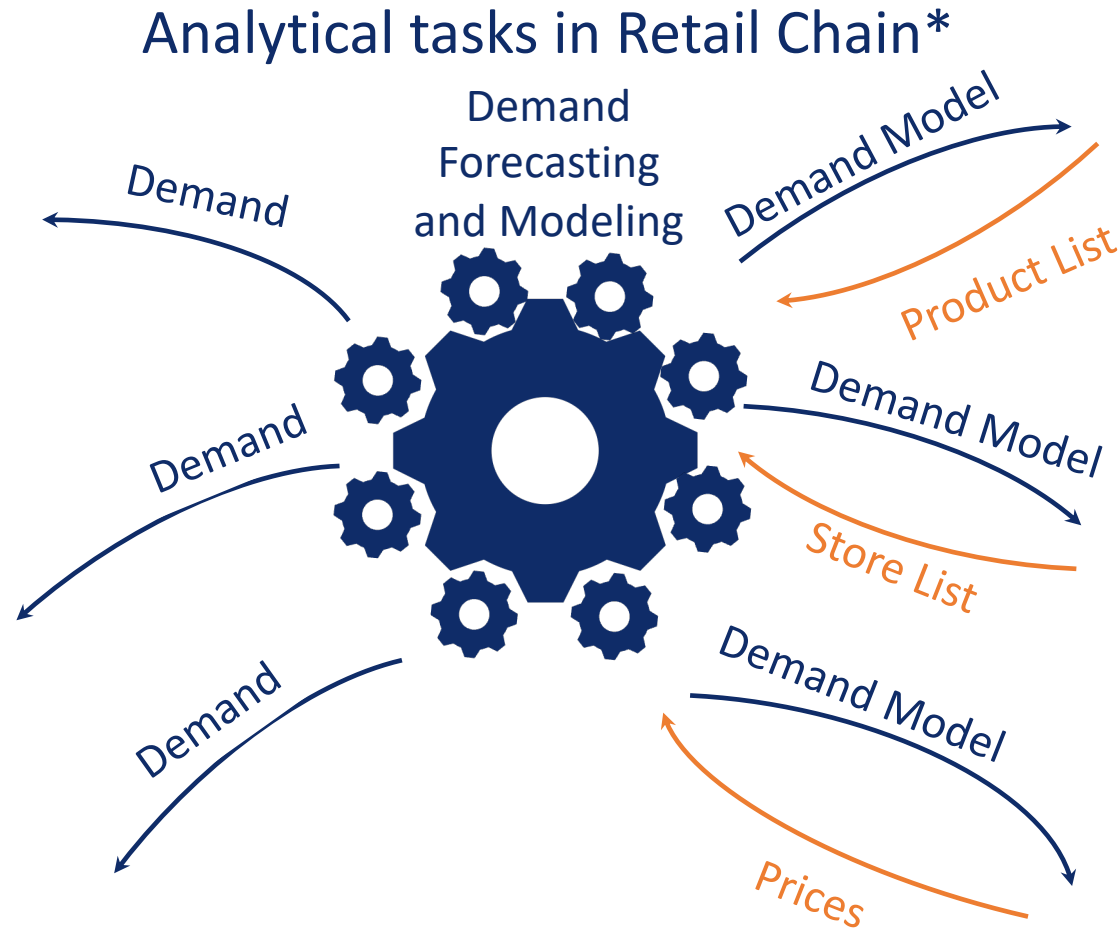
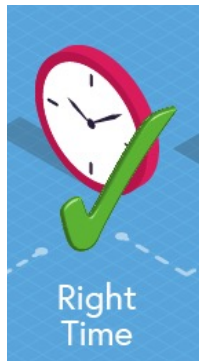
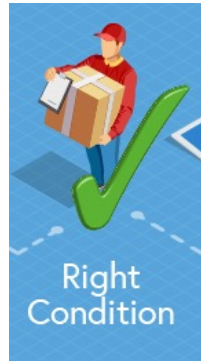
alexromsput@gmail.com



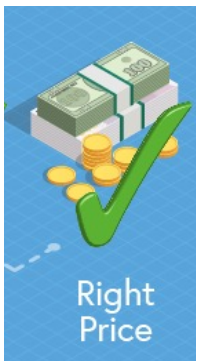
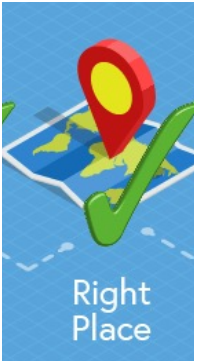
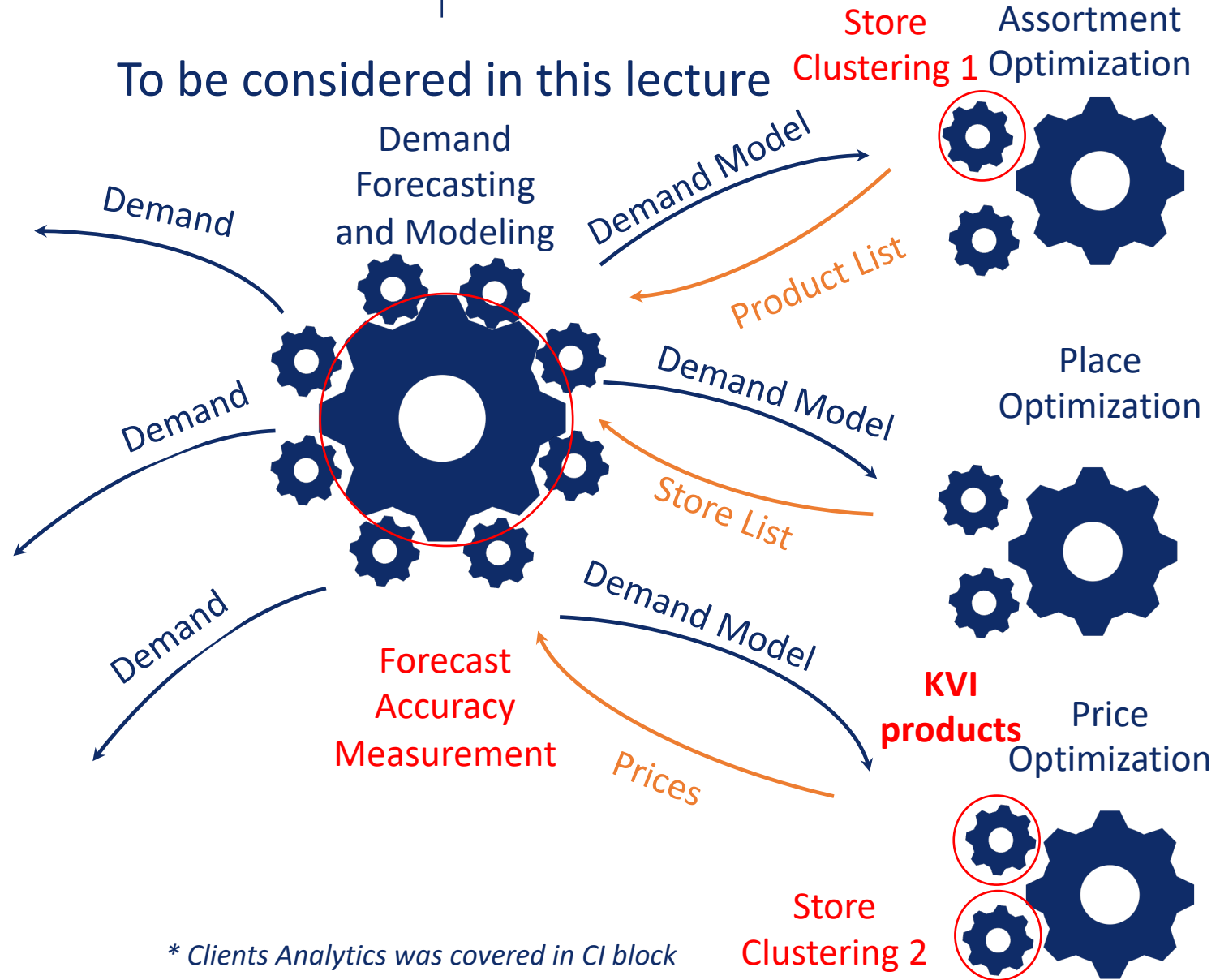
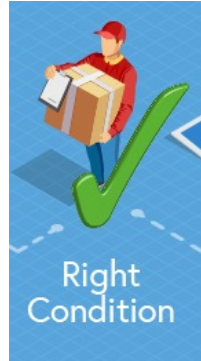
Agenda

- Forecast Accuracy Measurement
- Store Clusterization in Retail
- Building KVI products
- HW #3
 - Demand Forecasting





* Clients Analytics was covered in CI block



How to Best Measure...

..Forecast Error





Accuracy Business Measures

	id1	id2	id3	id4
Actual	1	10	10	1
Forecast	10	9	1	2

Items					
id1					
Id2					
Id3					
Id4					
all					



Accuracy Business Measures

	id1	id2	id3	id4
Actual	1	10	10	1
Forecast	10	9	1	2

Items	Mean Squared Error MSE $1/n \cdot \sum (F - A)^2$				
id1	81				
Id2	1				
Id3	81				
Id4	1				
all	41				



Accuracy Business Measures

	id1	id2	id3	id4
Actual	1	10	10	1
Forecast	10	9	1	2

Items	Mean Squared Error MSE $1/n \cdot \sum (F - A)^2$	Mean Absolute Error MAE $1/n \cdot \sum F - A $			
id1	81	9			
Id2	1	1			
Id3	81	9			
Id4	1	1			
all	41	5			



Accuracy Business Measures

	id1	id2	id3	id4
Actual	1	10	10	1
Forecast	10	9	1	2

Items	Mean Squared Error MSE $1/n \cdot \sum (F - A)^2$	Mean Absolute Error MAE $1/n \cdot \sum F - A $	MA Percentage Error MAPE $1/n \cdot \sum (F - A /A)$		
id1	81	9	900%		
Id2	1	1	10%		
Id3	81	9	90%		
Id4	1	1	100%		
all	41	5	275%		



Accuracy Business Measures

	id1	id2	id3	id4
Actual	1	10	10	1
Forecast	10	9	1	2

Items	Mean Squared Error MSE $1/n \cdot \sum (F - A)^2$	Mean Absolute Error MAE $1/n \cdot \sum F - A $	MA Percentage Error MAPE $1/n \cdot \sum (F - A /A)$	Weighted APE WAPE $\sum F - A / \sum A $	
id1	81	9	900%	900%	
Id2	1	1	10%	10%	
Id3	81	9	90%	90%	
Id4	1	1	100%	100%	
all	41	5	275%	20/22*100%	



MAPE vs WAPE

$$MAPE = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i: SKU, TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} = \sum_{SKU, TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} \cdot \frac{1}{n}$$



MAPE vs WAPE

$$MAPE = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i: SKU, TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} = \sum_{SKU, TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} \cdot \frac{1}{n}$$

 w_i



MAPE vs WAPE

$$MAPE = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i: SKU, TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} = \sum_{SKU, TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} \cdot \frac{1}{n}$$


 w_i

This is a weight of an item i



MAPE vs WAPE

$$MAPE = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i: SKU, TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} = \sum_{SKU, TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} \cdot \frac{1}{n}$$

 w_i

This is a weight of an item i

In WAPE case a weight of an item is proportional to its actual volume:

$$w_i = \frac{A_i}{\sum_{j: SKU, TT} A_j}$$



MAPE vs WAPE

$$MAPE = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i:SKU,TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} = \sum_{SKU,TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} \cdot \frac{1}{n}$$


 w_i

This is a weight of an item i

In WAPE case a weight of an item is proportional to its actual volume:

$$w_i = \frac{A_i}{\sum_{j:SKU,TT} A_j}$$

$$WAPE = \sum_{i:SKU,TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} \cdot w_i = \sum_{i:SKU,TT} \frac{|F_i - A_i|}{A_i} \cdot \frac{A_i}{\sum_{j:SKU,TT} A_j} = \frac{\sum_{i:SKU,TT} |F_i - A_i|}{\sum_{j:SKU,TT} A_j}$$



Accuracy Business Measures

	id1	id2	id3	id4
Actual	1	10	10	1
Forecast	10	9	1	2

Items	Mean Squared Error MSE $1/n \cdot \sum (F - A)^2$	Mean Absolute Error MAE $1/n \cdot \sum F - A $	MA Percentage Error MAPE $1/n \cdot \sum (F - A /A)$	Weighted APE WAPE $\sum F - A / \sum A $	WA Predicted PE WAPPE $\sum F - A / \sum F $
id1	81	9	900%	900%	90%
Id2	1	1	10%	10%	1/9*100%
Id3	81	9	90%	90%	900%
Id4	1	1	100%	100%	50%
all	41	5	275%	20/22*100%	20/22*100%



Accuracy Business Measures

$$MAE = \sum |F - A|$$

- + Consider weight of items in the company
- + Doesn't stimulate nor Overforecasting or UnderForecasting Issues
- Lack of interpretability (it is not clear whether is good or not when $MAE = 10000$)

$$MAPE = \frac{1}{n} \sum \frac{|F - A|}{|A|}$$

- + Is interpretable
- + Marks cases with abnormally high losses (can be more than 100%)
- Doesn't Consider weight of items in the company
- Stimulates UnderForecasting Issues

$$WMAPE = \frac{\sum |F - A|}{\sum |A|}$$

- + Is interpretable
- + Consider weight of items in the company
- + Marks cases with abnormally high losses (can be more than 100%)
- Stimulates UnderForecasting Issues



Accuracy Business Measures

$$WAPPE = \frac{\sum(|F - A|)}{\sum F}$$

- + Is interpretable
- + Consider weight of items in the company
- + Marks cases with abnormally high losses (can be more than 100%)
- + **Stimulates OverForecasting Issues**

$$SWAPE = \frac{2 \sum(|F - A|)}{\sum F + \sum A}$$

- + Is interpretable
- + Consider weight of items in the company
- + Doesn't stimulate nor Overforecasting or UnderForecasting Issues
- + Accuracy = 1 - WAMAXPE
- **Doesn't mark cases with abnormally high losses (can not be more than 100%)**

$$WAMAXPE = \frac{\sum(|F - A|)}{\sum \max(|A|, |F|)}$$

- + Is interpretable
- + Consider weight of items in the company
- + Doesn't stimulate nor Overforecasting or UnderForecasting Issues
- + Accuracy = 1 - WAMAXPE
- + **Doesn't mark cases with abnormally high losses (can not be more than 100%)**



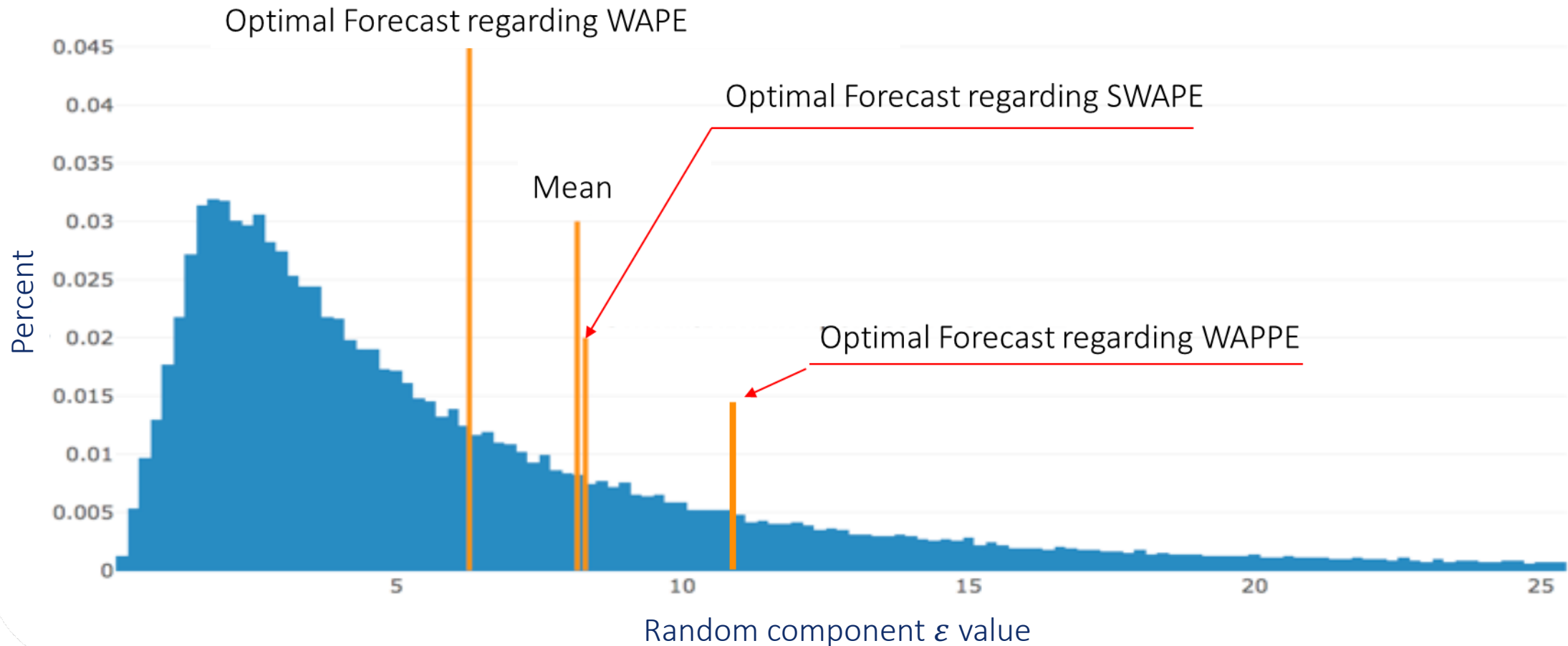
Selection of the Forecast Accuracy Criterion

- Questions:
 - Does Accuracy Criterion affect on Forecast Values?
 - ✓ Yes
 - Does Accuracy Criterion affect on the Best Forecasting Approach (Algorithm)?
 - ✓ Yes
 - If Top managers decided to change Forecast Accuracy Criterion, will it require the re-estimation of forecasting algorithms?
 - ✓ Yes



Forecast Value Highly Depends on Accuracy Measure. Experiment on real data

Random component ε Distribution, based on 10^6 items





Demand = Deterministic Component + *Random*

Volume

&

Volatility





Demand = Deterministic Component + *Random*

Volume

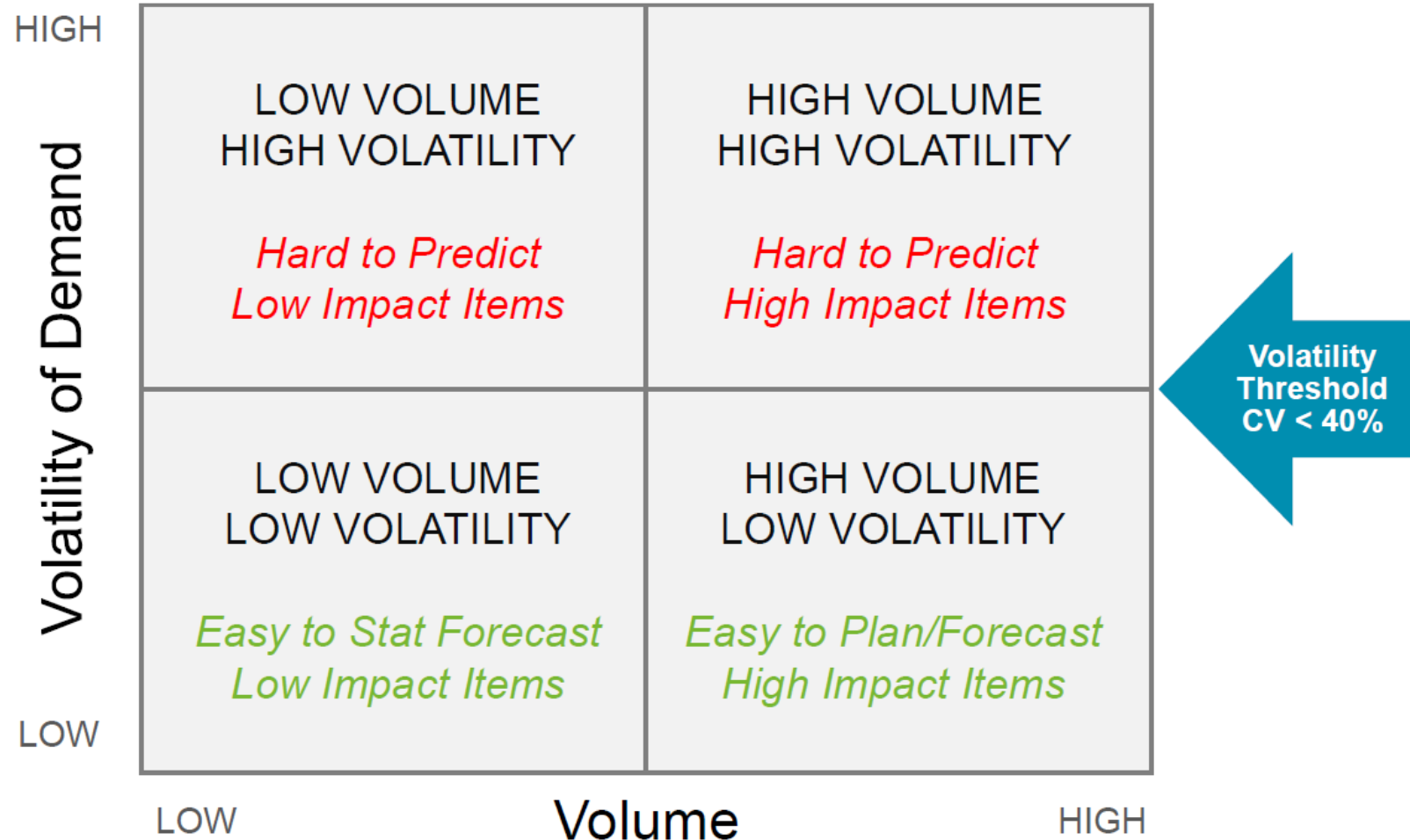
&

Volatility

$$CV_i = \text{Var}(\text{Random}_i) / \text{Deterministic_Component}$$



Product/Location Segmentation approach

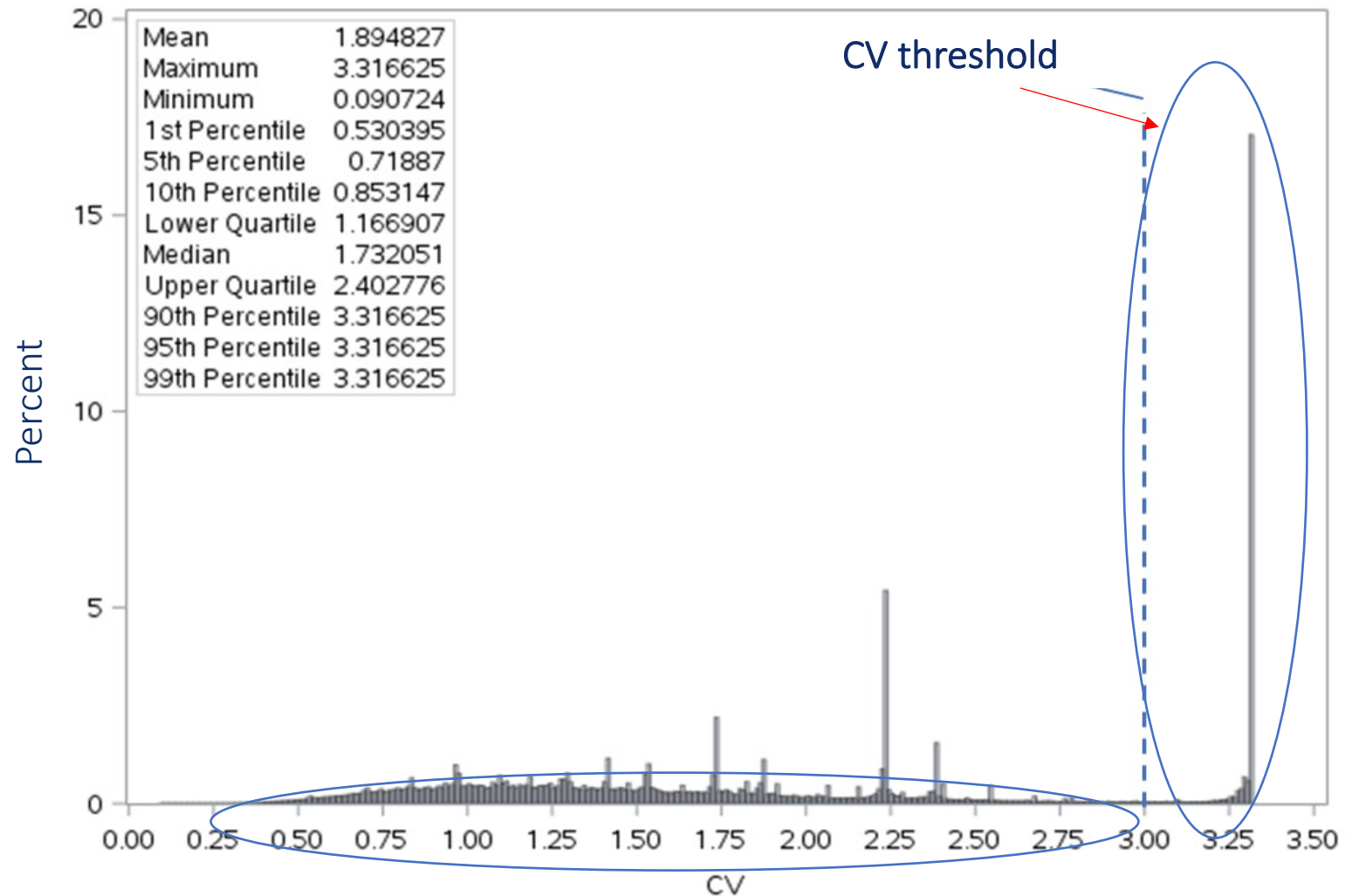




How to define CV Threshold? EM-based clustering

- Approach #1:
Build bar chart and
define threshold
manually
- Approach #2
Run EM algorithm on
CV values (1-column
train set)

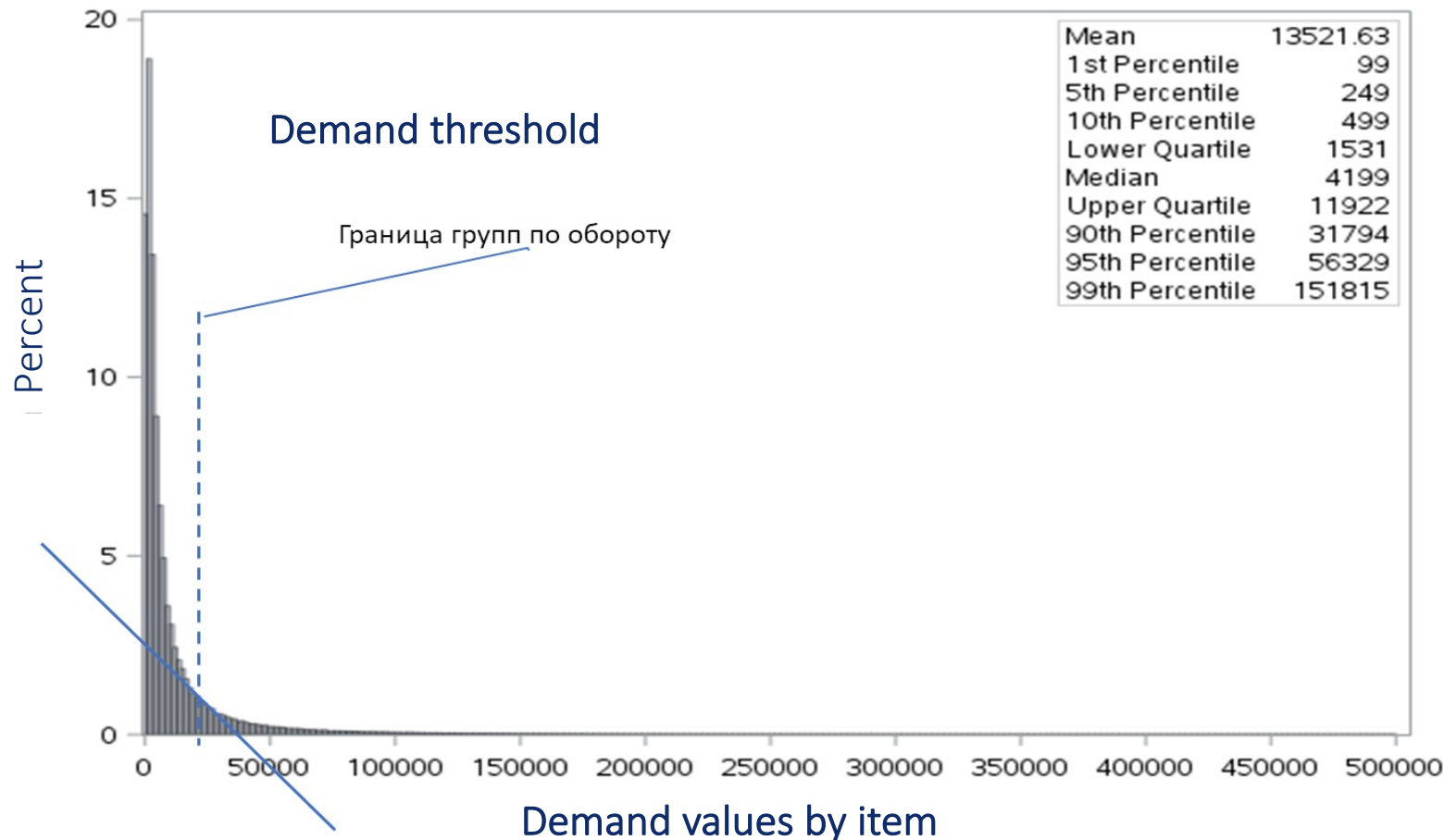
Bar chart of CV values of different items





How to define Demand Threshold

Bar chart of demand values by items



- Method of tangents
- Method of polygon
- Method of loop
- Method of triangle (the most flexible one)



WAPE = $\geq 50\%$

Volatility of Demand

WAPE = 20%-30%



How to set up Benchmark for Accuracy?

LOW VOLUME HIGH VOLATILITY <i>Hard to Predict Low Impact Items</i>	HIGH VOLUME HIGH VOLATILITY <i>Hard to Predict High Impact Items</i>
LOW VOLUME LOW VOLATILITY <i>Easy to Stat Forecast Low Impact Items</i>	HIGH VOLUME LOW VOLATILITY <i>Easy to Plan/Forecast High Impact Items</i>

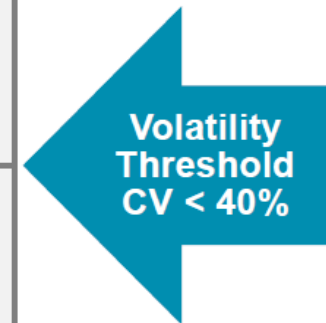
LOW

Volume

HIGH



WAPE = 40%-50%

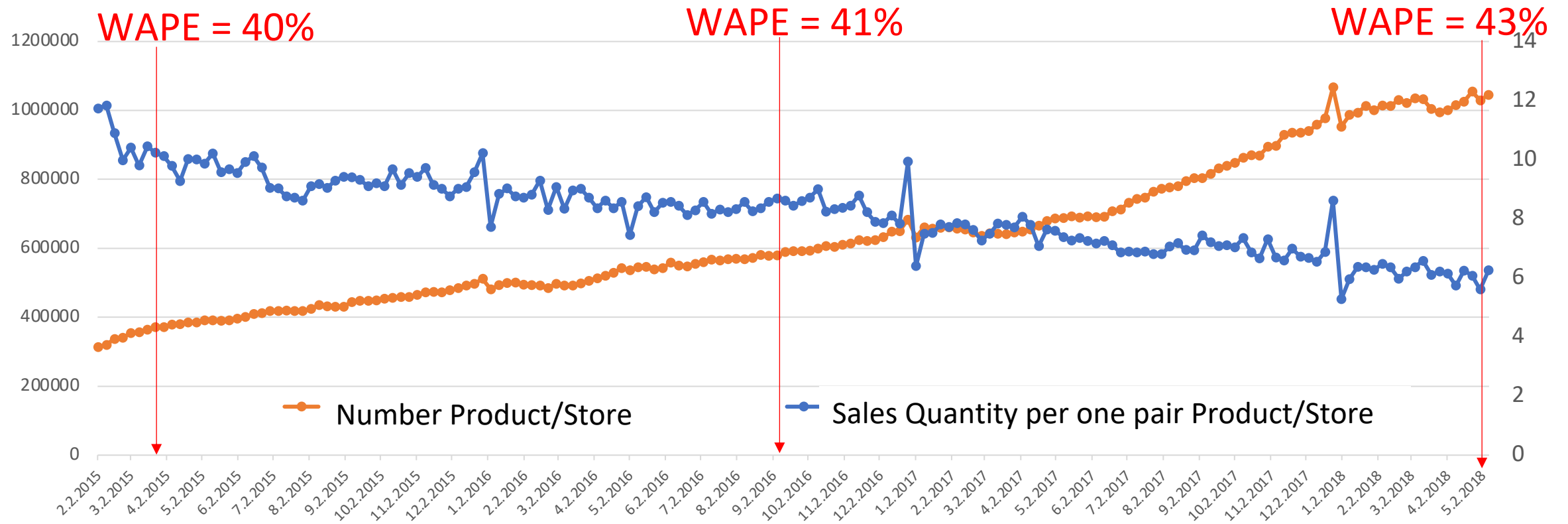


WAPE = 10%-20%





Accuracy dependance on Assortment Dynamics



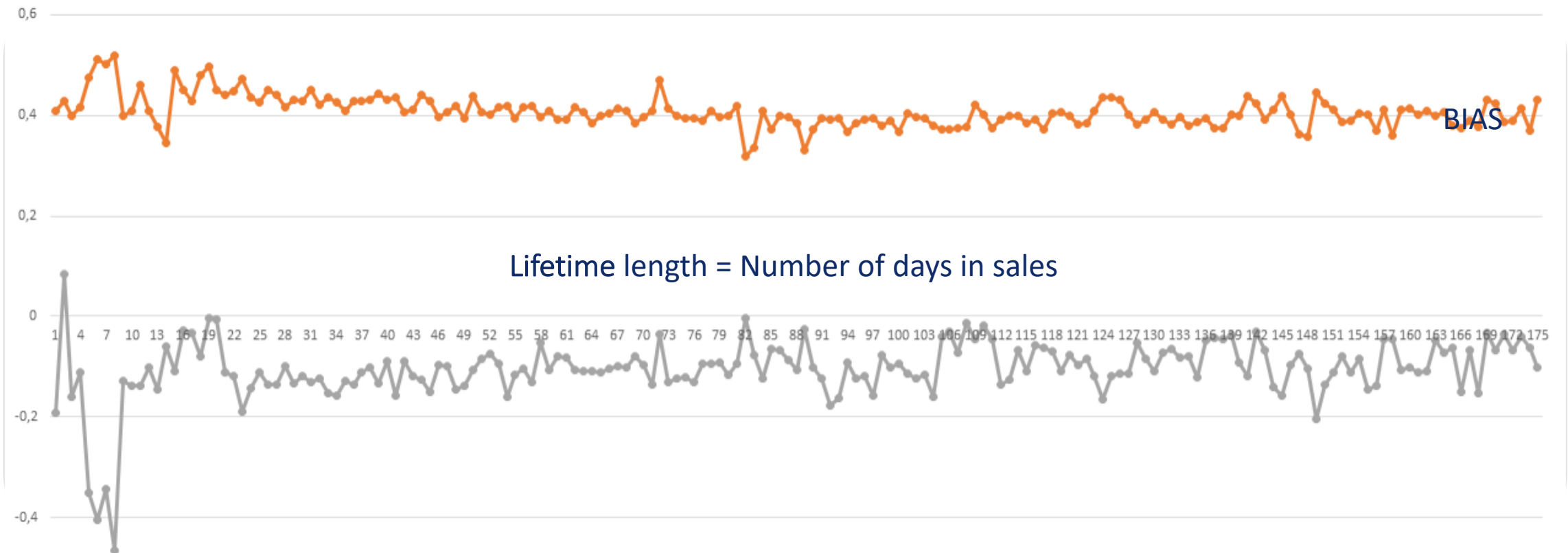
Dynamics of Number of active pairs Product / Store in the Assortment Matrix



Accuracy Depending on of the Sales History Length

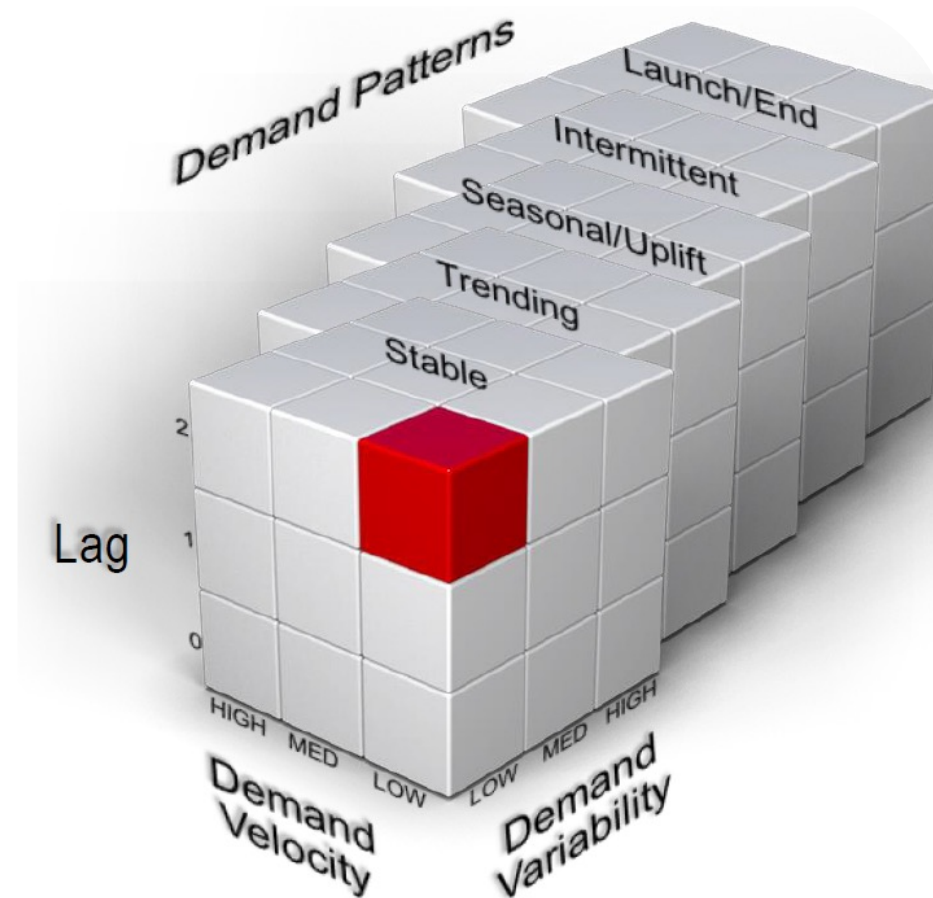
WAPE

WAPE & BIAS vs Item Lifetime Length





Demand Forecasting Units Segmentation based on Forecastability





Agenda

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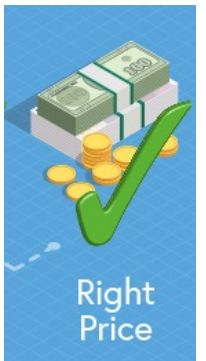
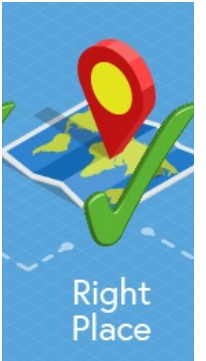
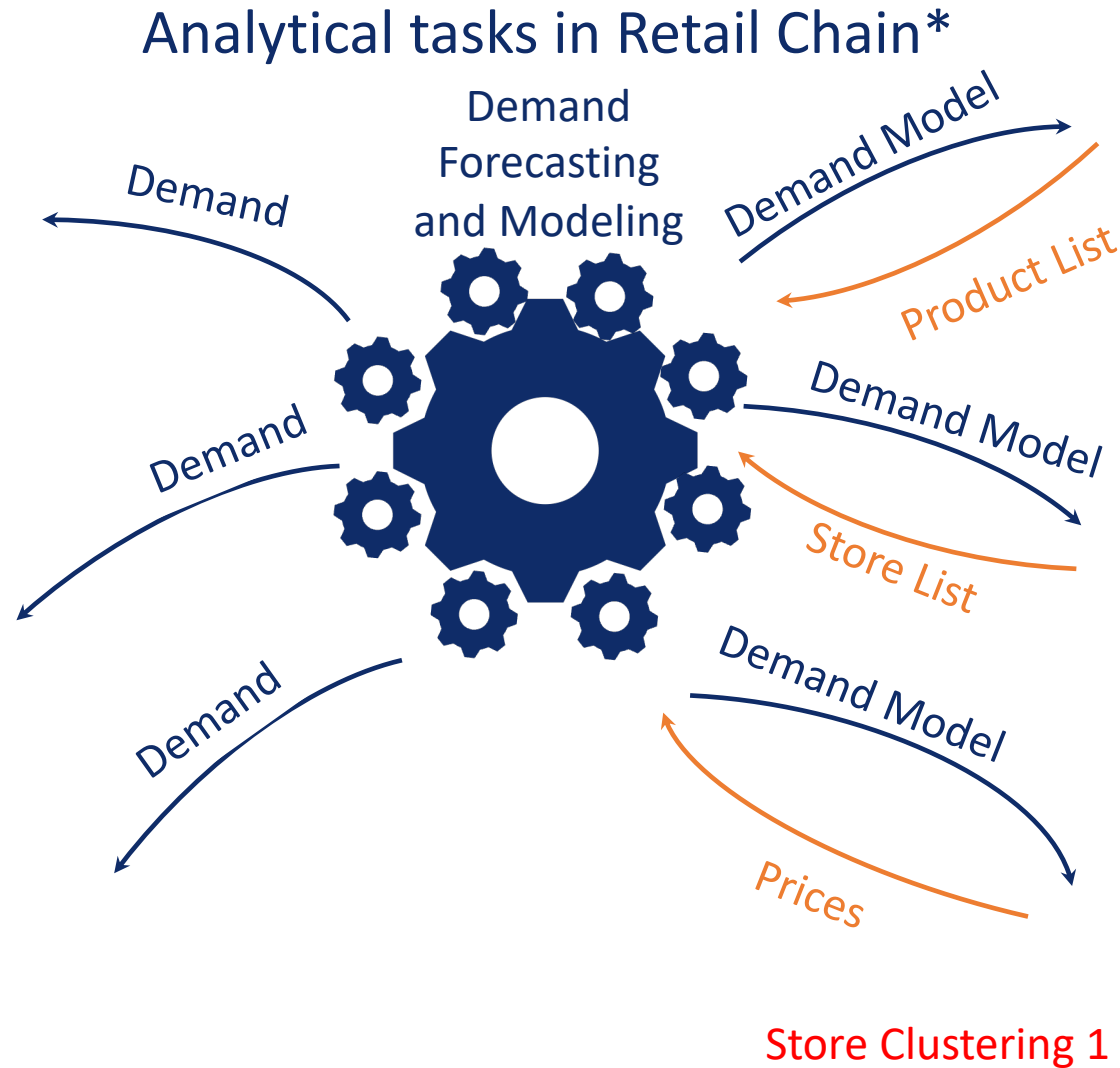
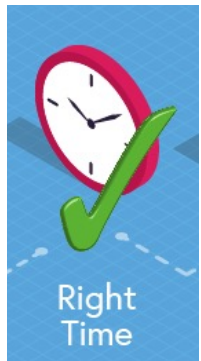
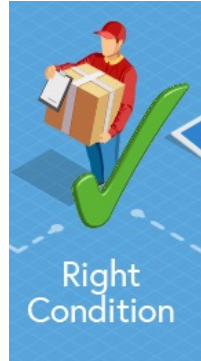
Определение корзин KVI

Постановка задачи:

1. Определить список KVI товаров, вычислив KVI Score критерии
2. Определить оптимальный порог для KVI Score критерия

Входные данные:

1. Мониторинг цен конкурентов
2. Чековые данные с 1 января по 31 марта 2018 года
3. Список ТПЦ и СТМ



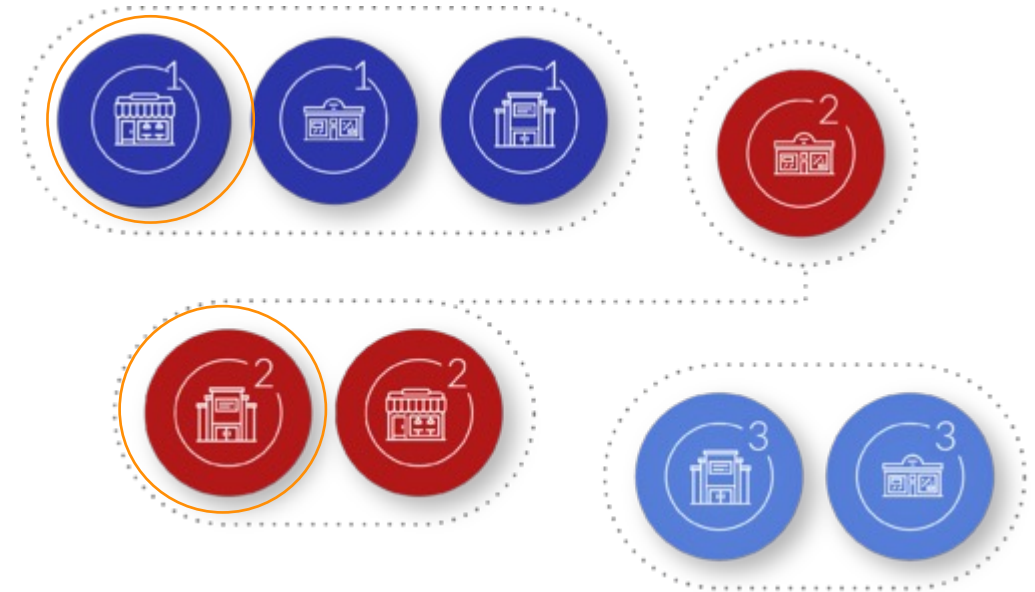
* Clients Analytics was covered in CI block



Requirement (Ideas) of Store Clusterization for Price Optimization

Why in different price-clusters?

- different Competitor Environment
- different Demand Structure
- different Clients





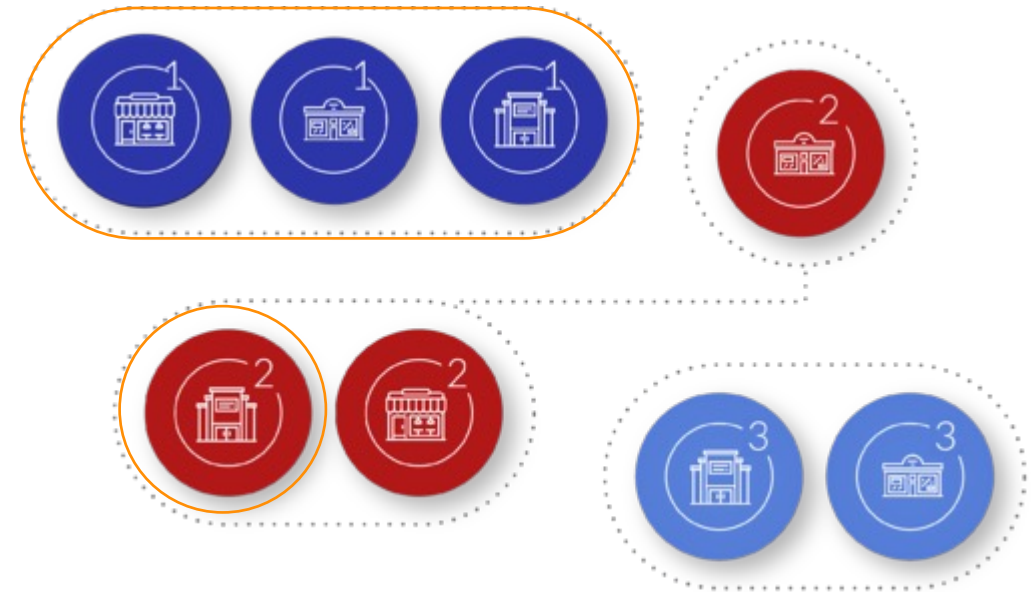
Requirement (Ideas) of Store Clusterization for Price Optimization

Why in different price-clusters?

- different Competitor Environment
- different Demand Structure
- different Clients

Why in the same price-cluster?

- the same Competitors and/or Demand Structure and/or Clients
- located close to each other (geolocation)





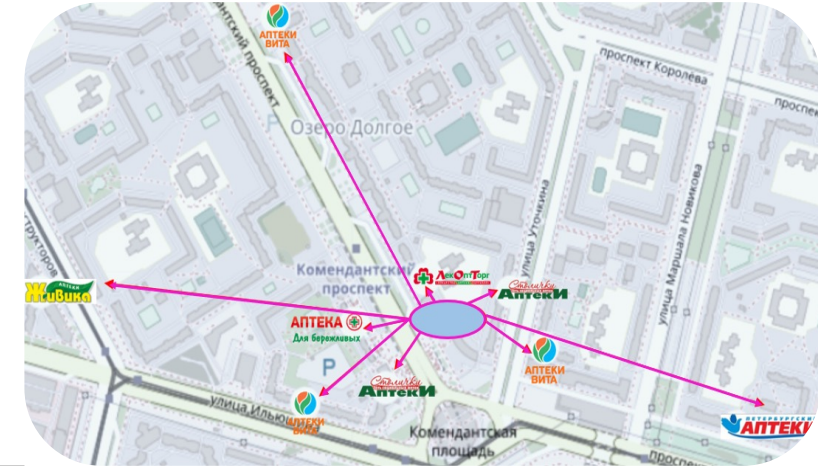
Clustering based on Competitive Environment

Method:



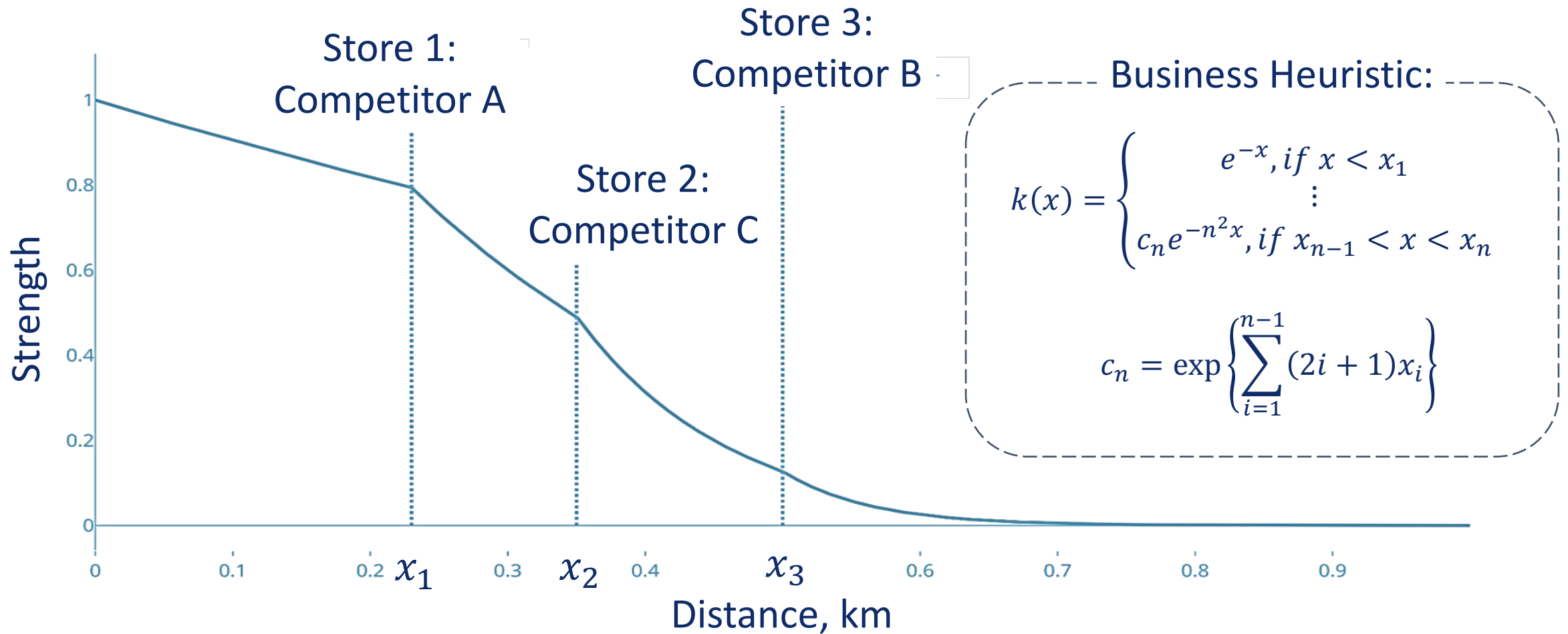
Train set example:

Store	Store 1 Strength	Store 2 Strength	Store 3 Strength	...	Store 15 Strength
1	13	10	5		0
2	10	9	6		1
3	14	10	5		0
4	18	7	7		0
5	19	8	7		1
6	18	9	5		0





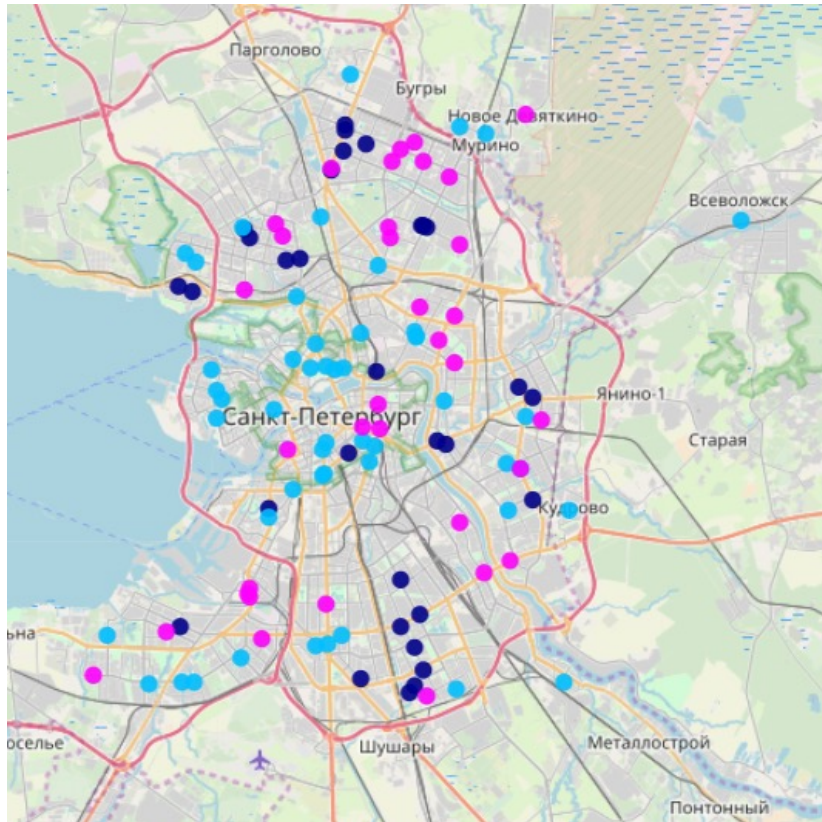
How to Calculate Competitor Strength



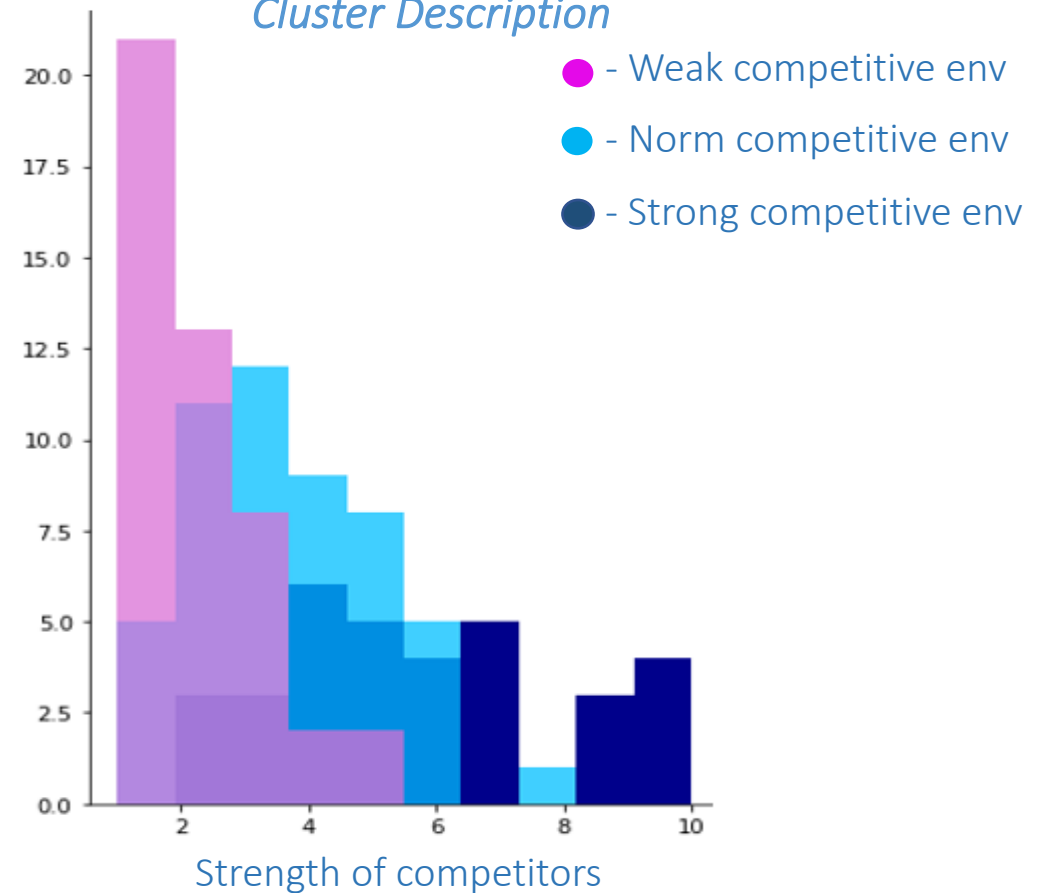


Results of Clusterization based on Competitive Environment

Clusterization Results

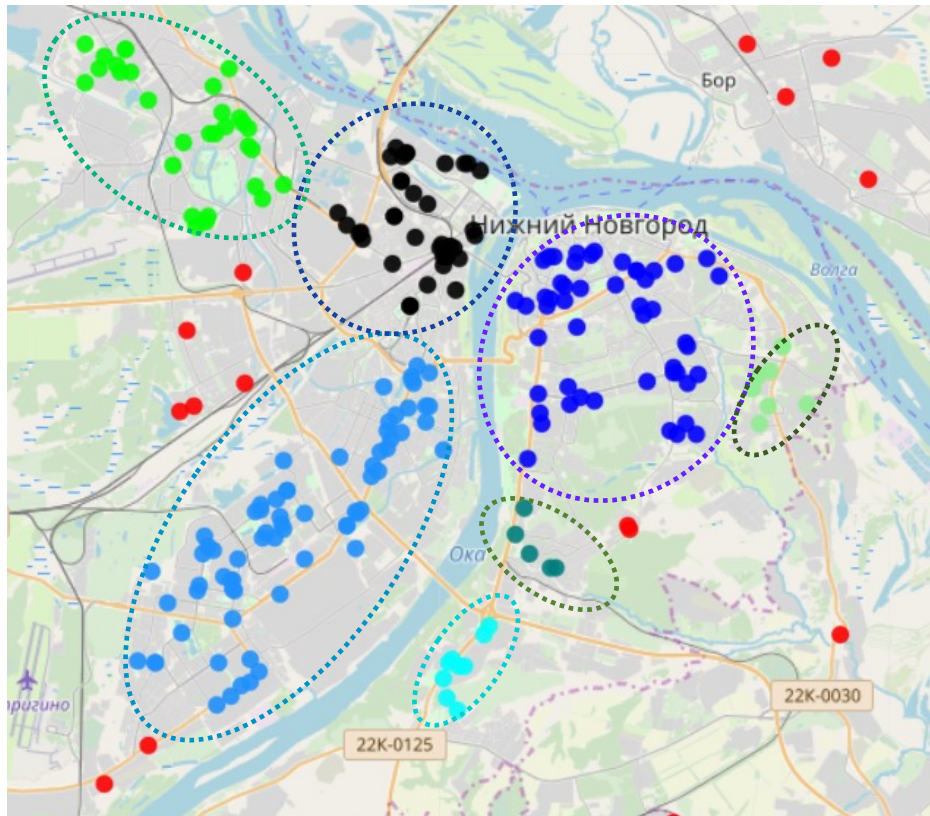


Cluster Description

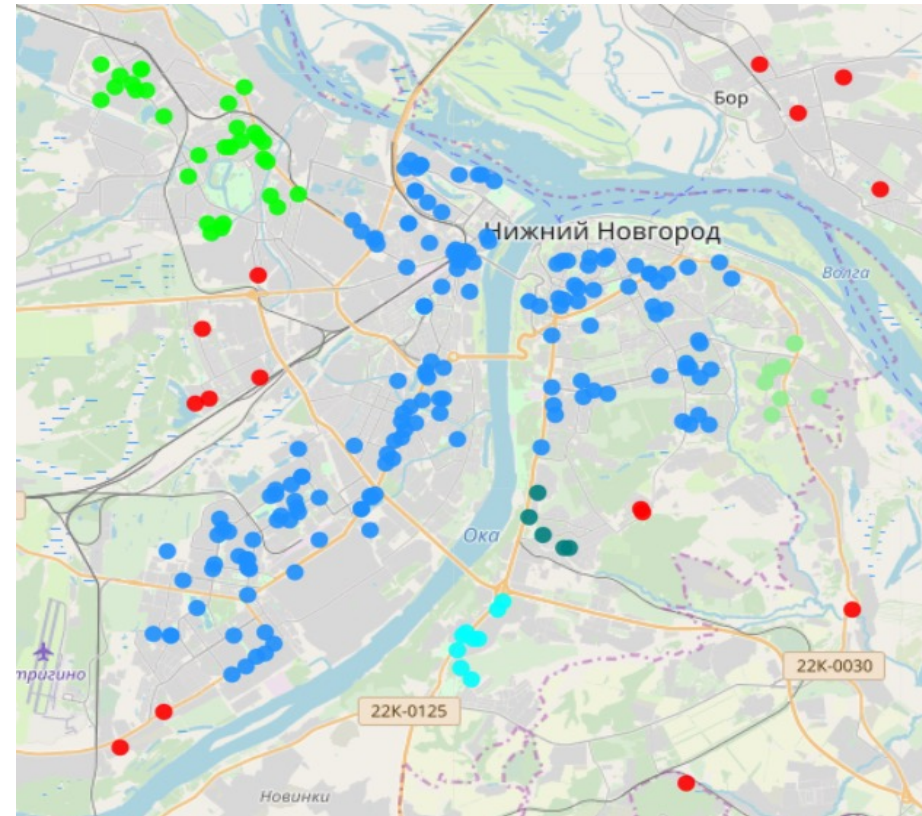


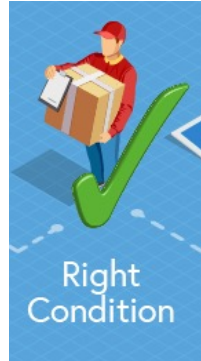
Clustering stores by distance using the example of a grocery chain.

Pic. 1: $\varepsilon = 15$ min.

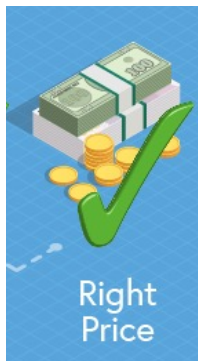
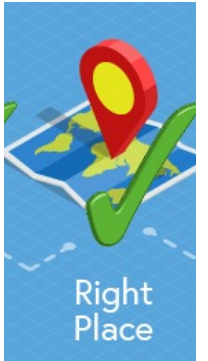
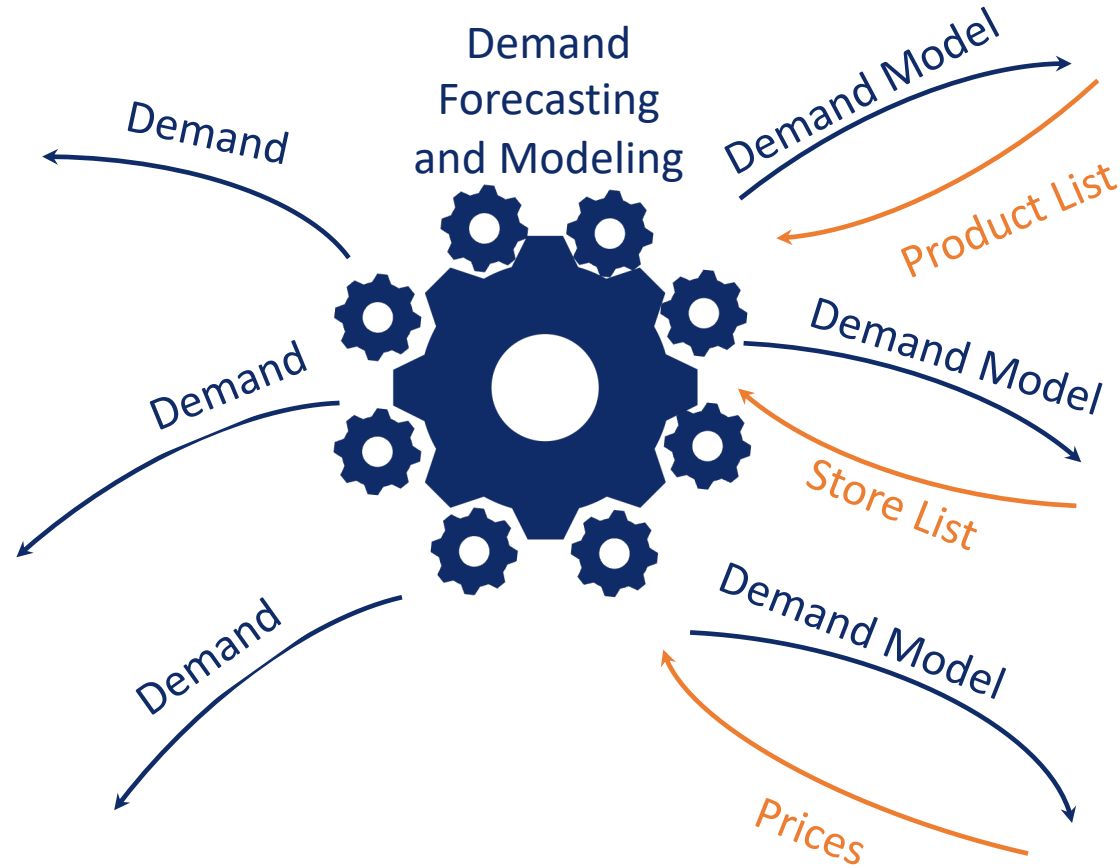


Pic. 2: $\varepsilon = 25$ min.





Store Clusterization for Assortment Optimization



* Clients Analytics was covered in CI block



Requirements (Ideas) of the Store Clusterization for Assortment Optimization

Key drivers for Clusterization:

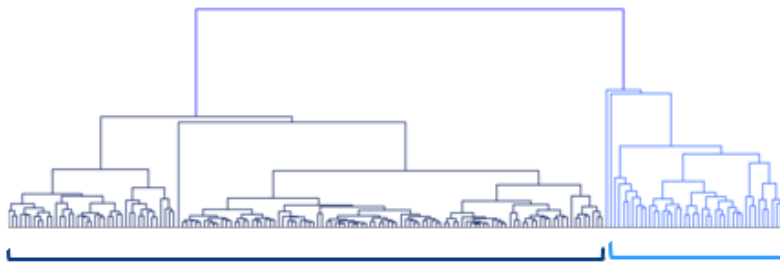
Prevailing categories in Sales
History



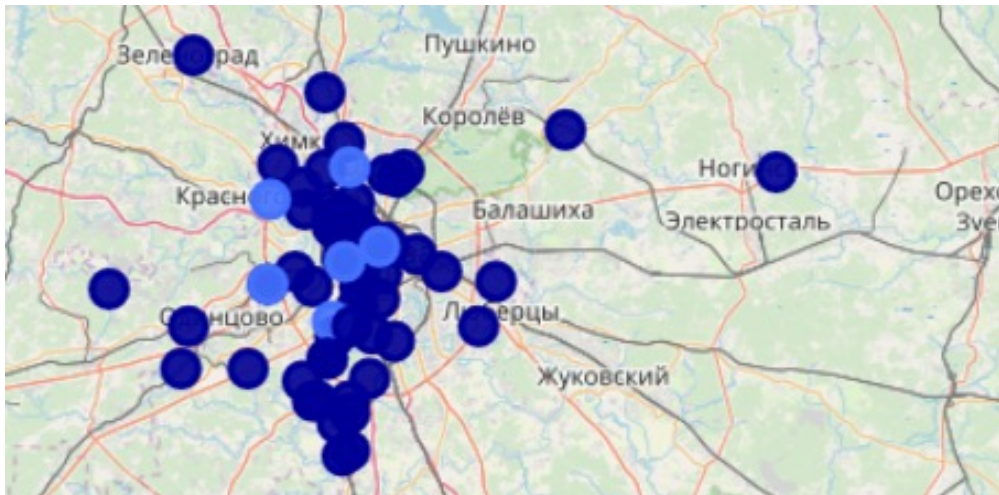


Clusterization based on Sales Structure

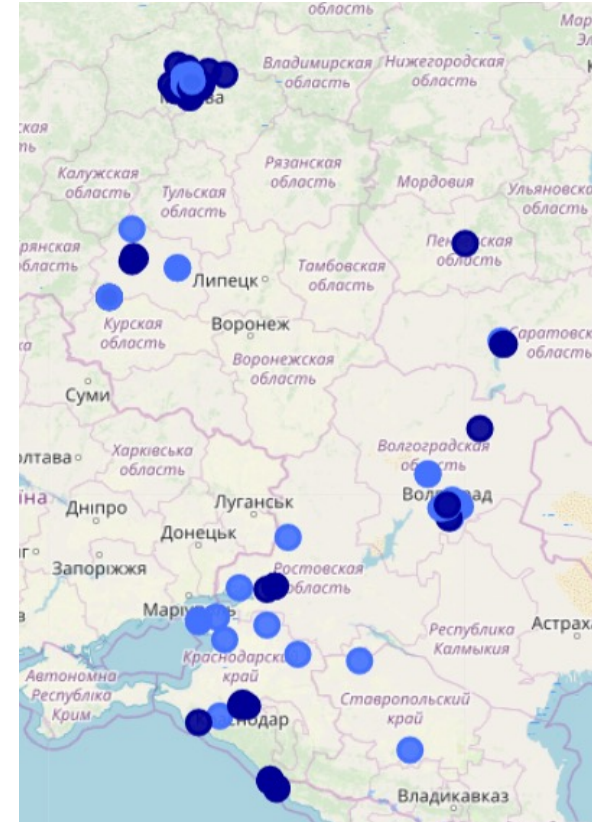
НА ДЕНДРОГРАММЕ МОЖНО ВЫДЕЛИТЬ 2 КЛАСТЕРА



RESULTS OF CLUSTERIZATION



RESULTS OF CLUSTERIZATION





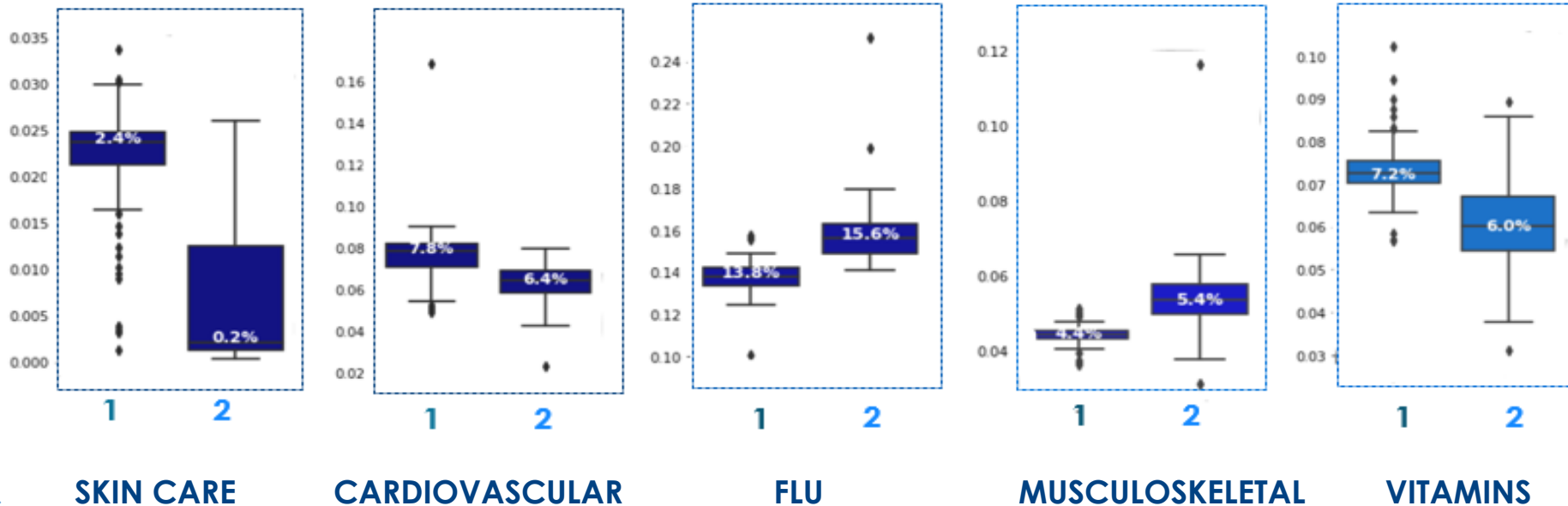
Interpretation of Clusterization Results

PREVAILING CATEGORIES STATISTICS

Cluster No.Stores Square Lifetime, years

1 → 137 → 95 (± 32) M2 → 4.8 (± 5)

2 → 42 → 59 (± 17) M2 → 2.6 (± 5)





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- Store Clusterization in Retail
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Defining KVI Baskets

Setting the task:

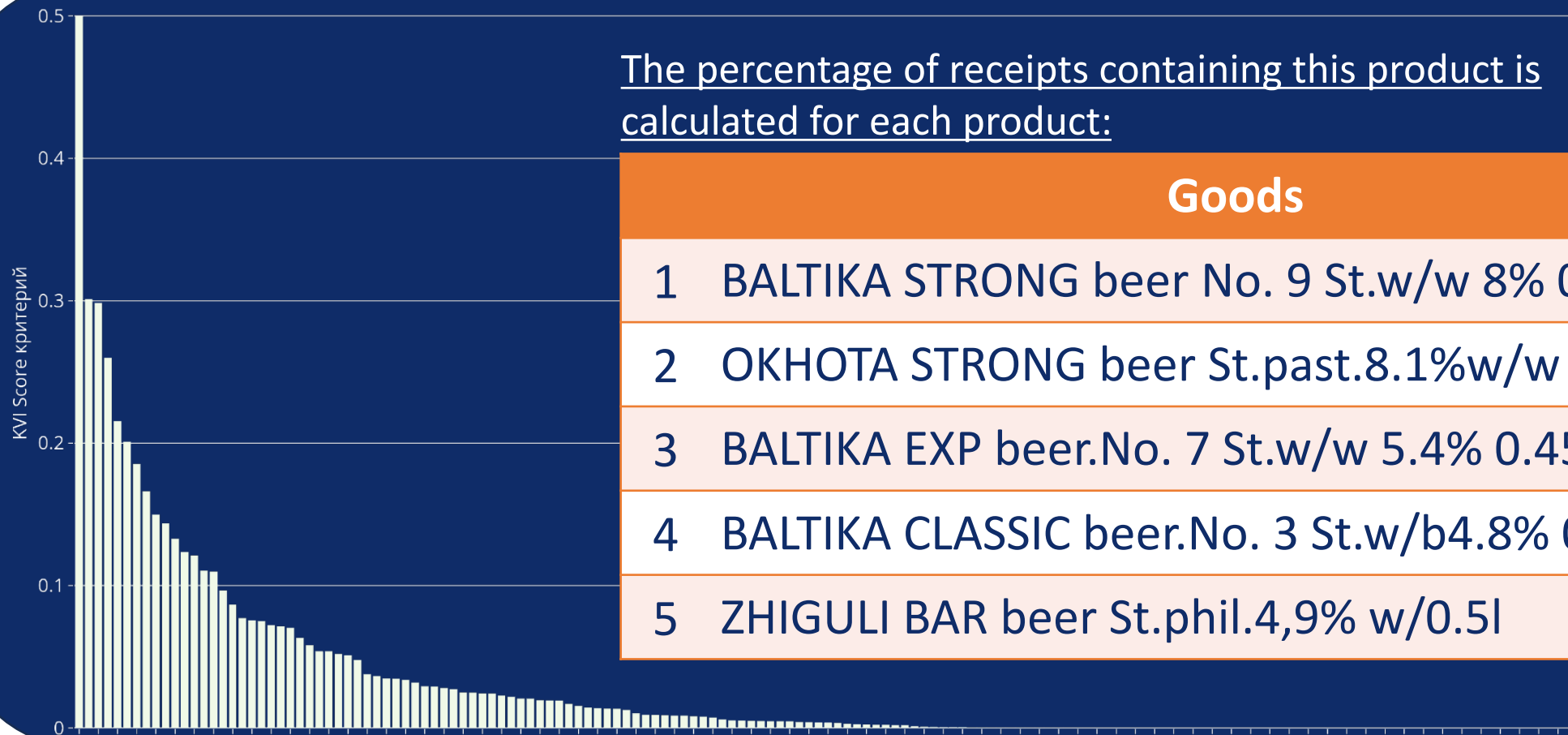
1. Determine the list of KVI products by calculating the KVI “Score” criteria
2. Determine the optimal threshold for the KVI Score criterion

Input data:

1. Competitor price monitoring
2. Receipt data from January 1 to March 31, 2018
3. List of shopping centers and STMs

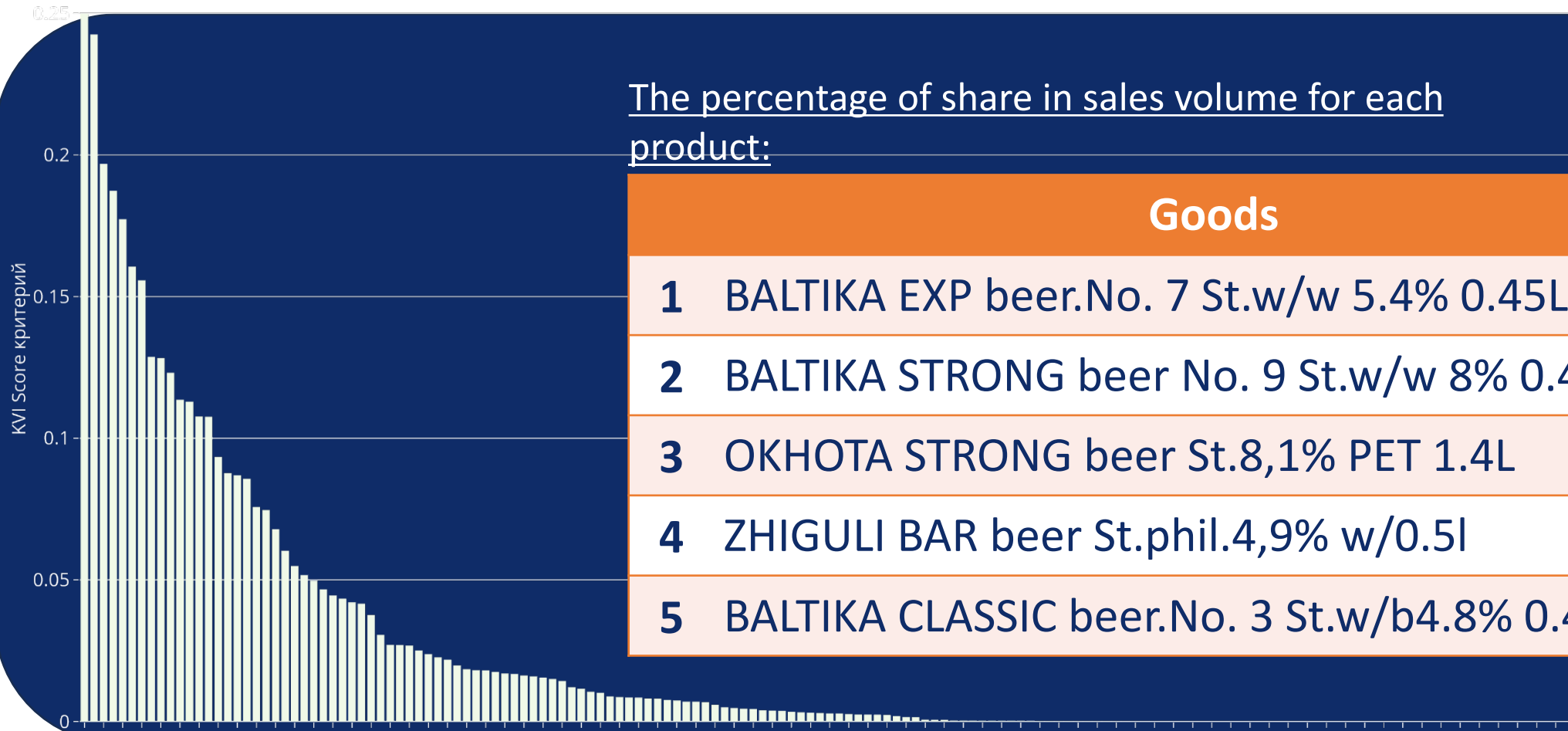


KVI Score criteria. Fitting into the cheque





KVI Score criteria. Share in sales volume



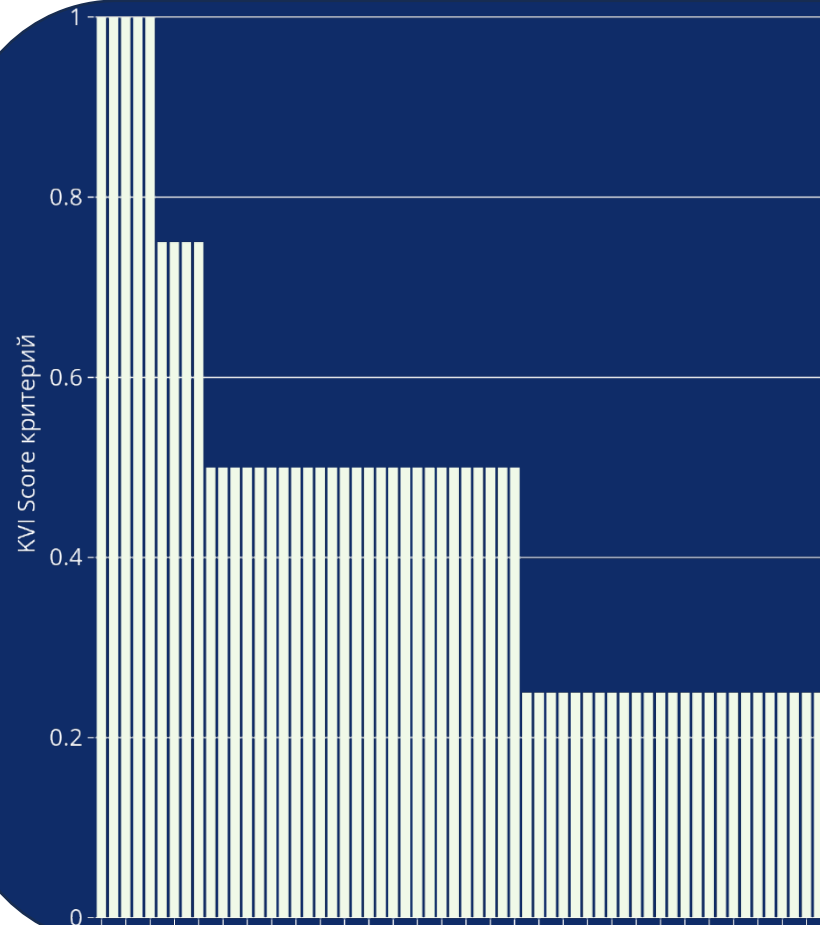


KVI Score criteria. The criterion of the share of buyers





KVI Score criteria. Criteria for the level of competition



For each product, the percentage of customers buying this product is calculated.:

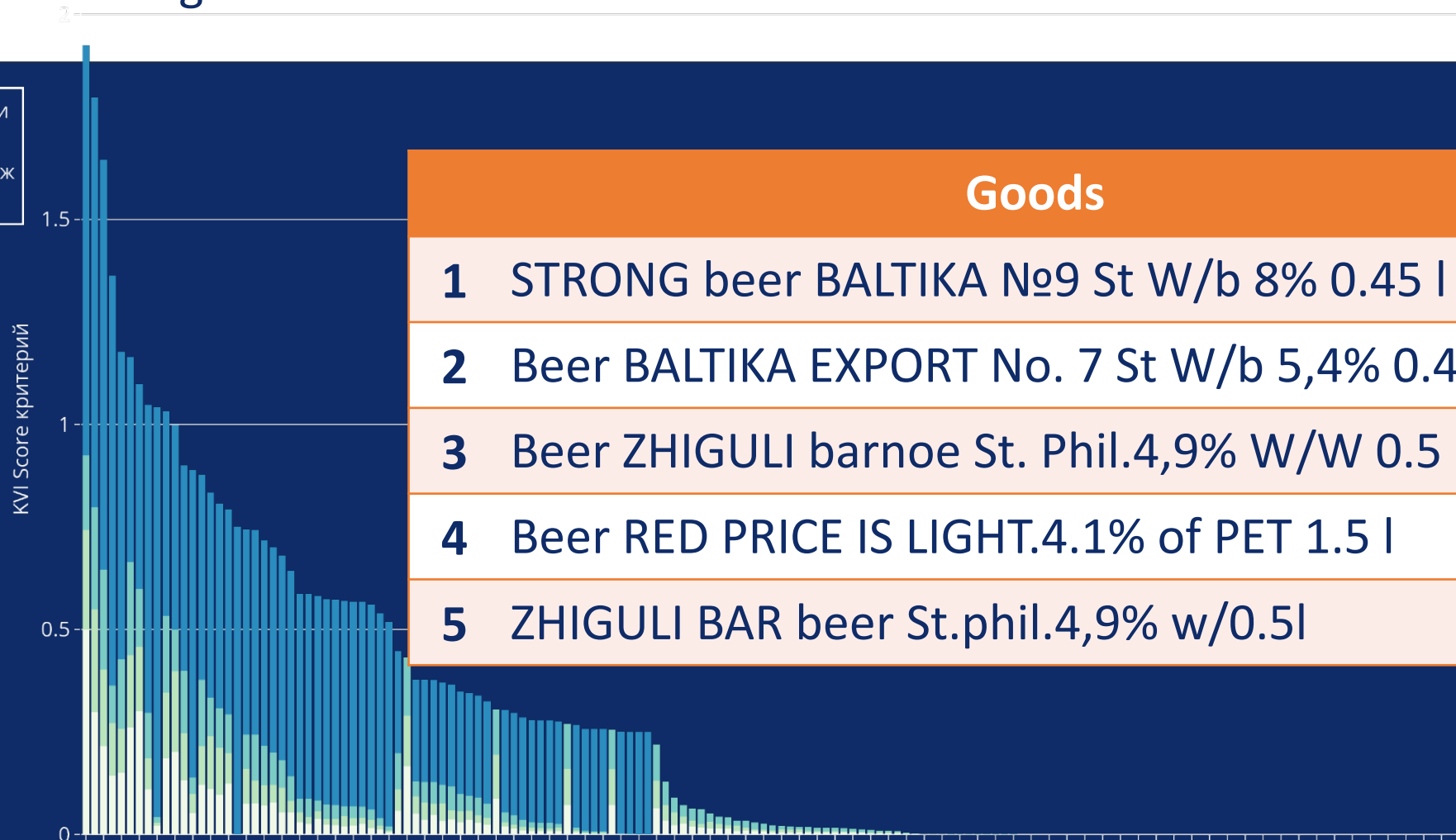
Goods

- 1 BALTIKA STRONG beer No. 9 St.w/w 8% 0.45l
- 2 ZHIGULI BAR beer St.phil.4,9% w/0.5l
- 3 Beer RED PRICE IS LIGHT.4.1% PET 1.5L
- 4 BALTIKA EXP beer. No. 7 St.w/w 5.4% 0.45L
- 5 Beer KR.THE PRICE IS LIGHT.4.1% 0.5L



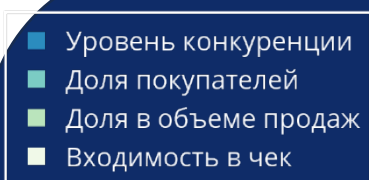
KVI Score criteria. A single KVI Score criterion

- Уровень конкуренции
- Доля покупателей
- Доля в объеме продаж
- Входимость в чек

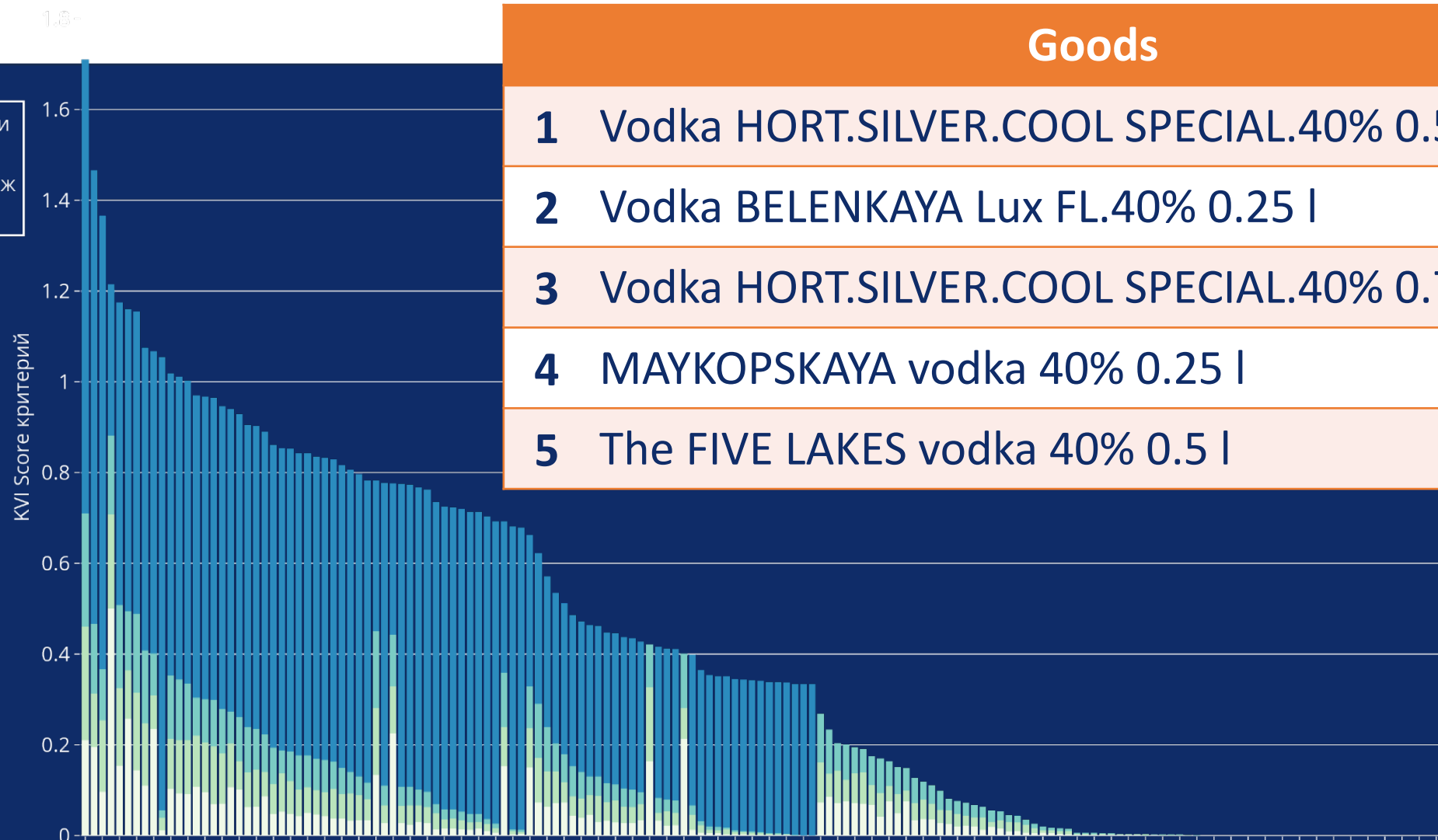




Examples



Vodka

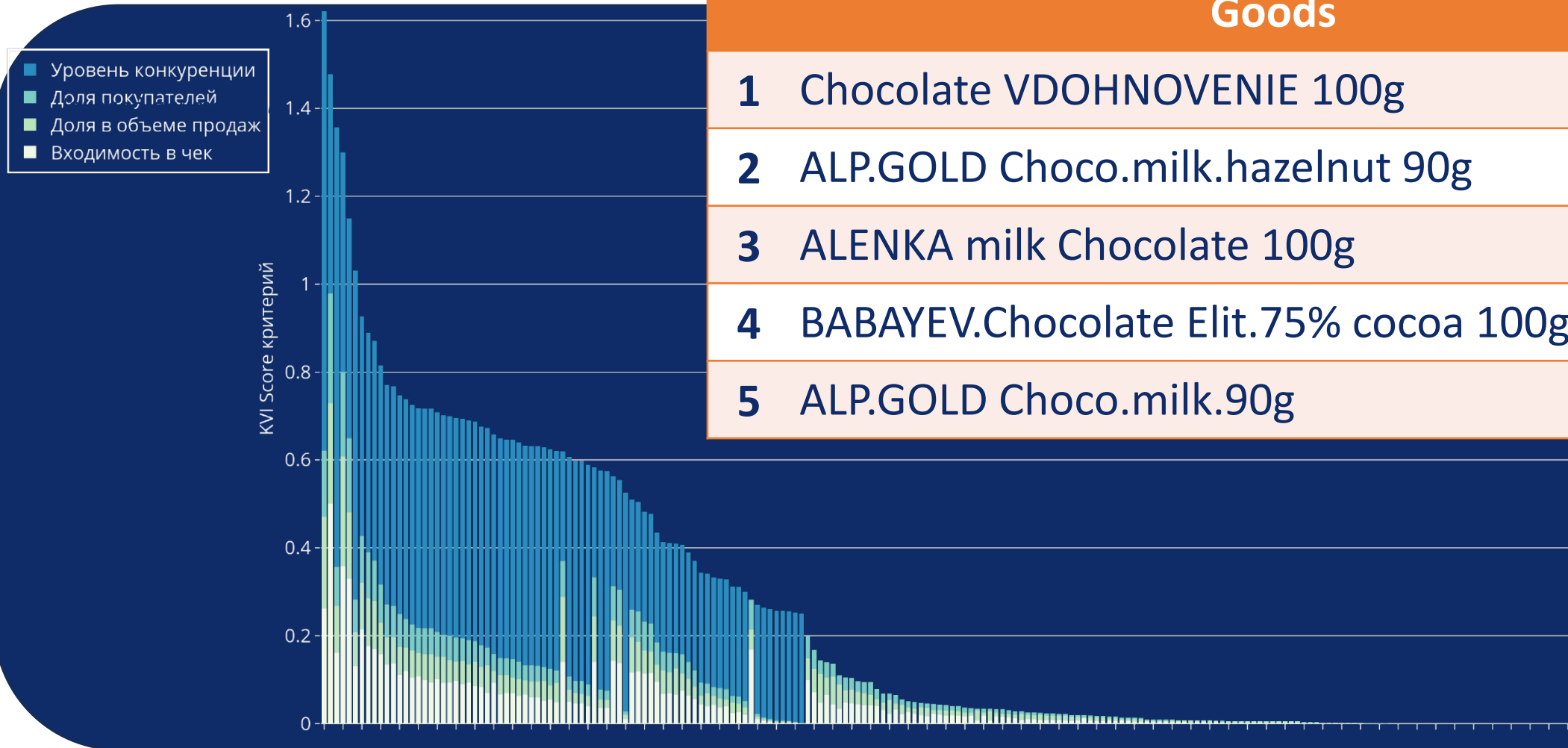


Goods

- 1 Vodka HORT.SILVER.COOL SPECIAL.40% 0.5 l
- 2 Vodka BELENKAYA Lux FL.40% 0.25 l
- 3 Vodka HORT.SILVER.COOL SPECIAL.40% 0.7 l
- 4 MAYKOPSKAYA vodka 40% 0.25 l
- 5 The FIVE LAKES vodka 40% 0.5 l



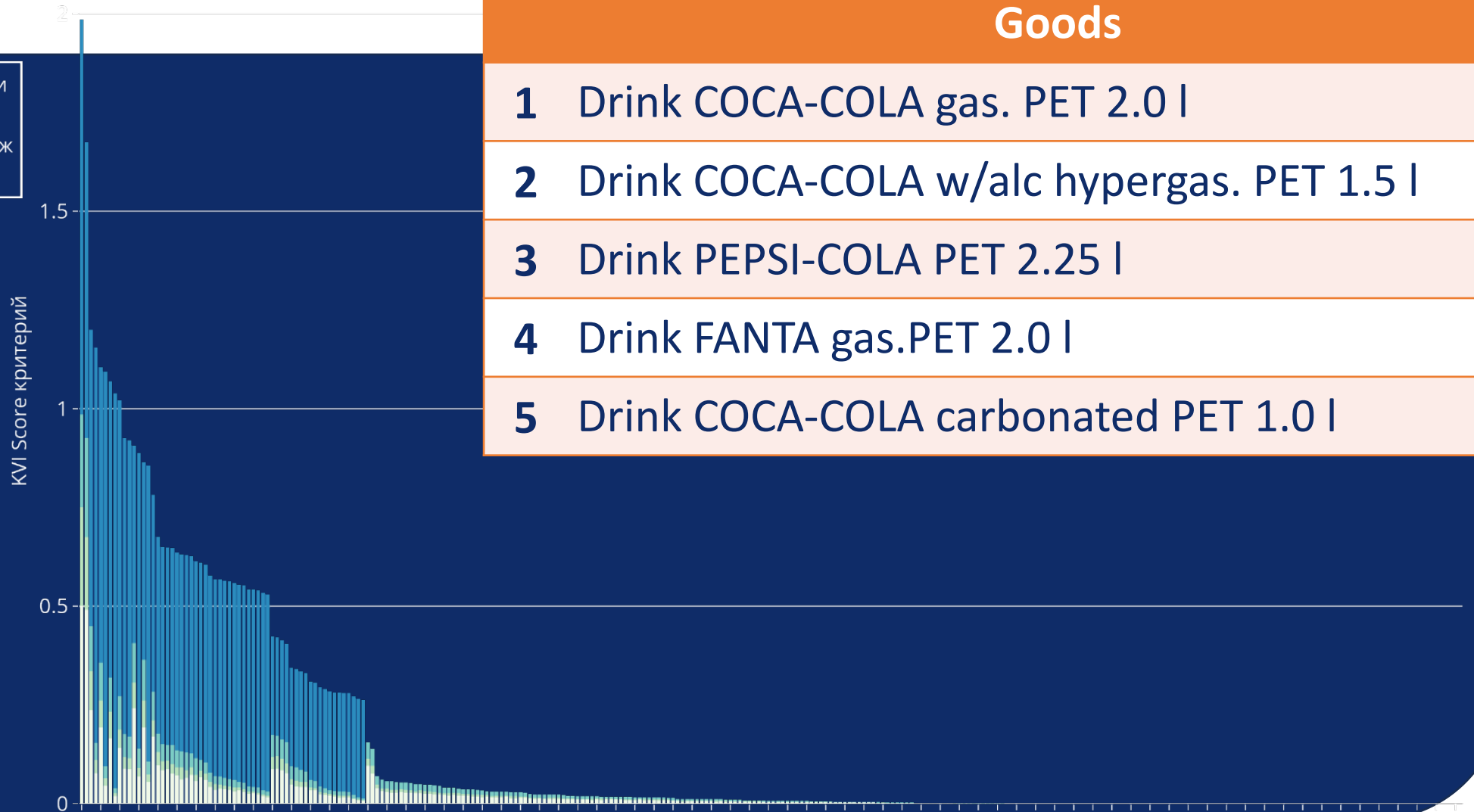
Examples





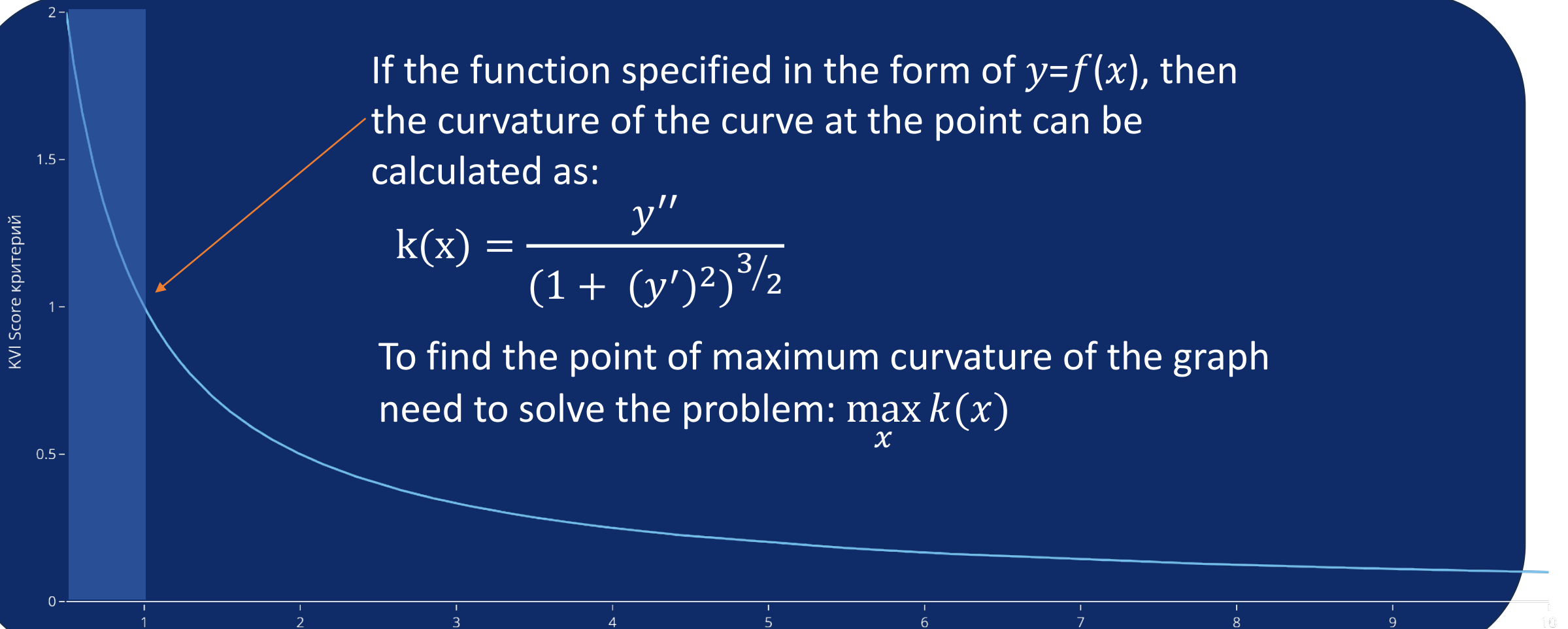
Examples

- Уровень конкуренции
- Доля покупателей
- Доля в объеме продаж
- Входимость в чек





The algorithm for determining the optimal threshold





The algorithm for determining the optimal threshold

Replace derivatives in their approximation:

$$y' \rightarrow u_{i+1} - u_i$$

$$y'' \rightarrow u_{i-1} - 2u_i + u_{i+1}$$

Calculate the coefficient of curvature k_i at each point and solve the optimization problem:

$$\max_i \left\{ k_i * \left| 1 - \frac{i}{n} \right|^{p+1} \right\}$$

where p is the priority category.

KVI Score критерий

1.5

1

0.5

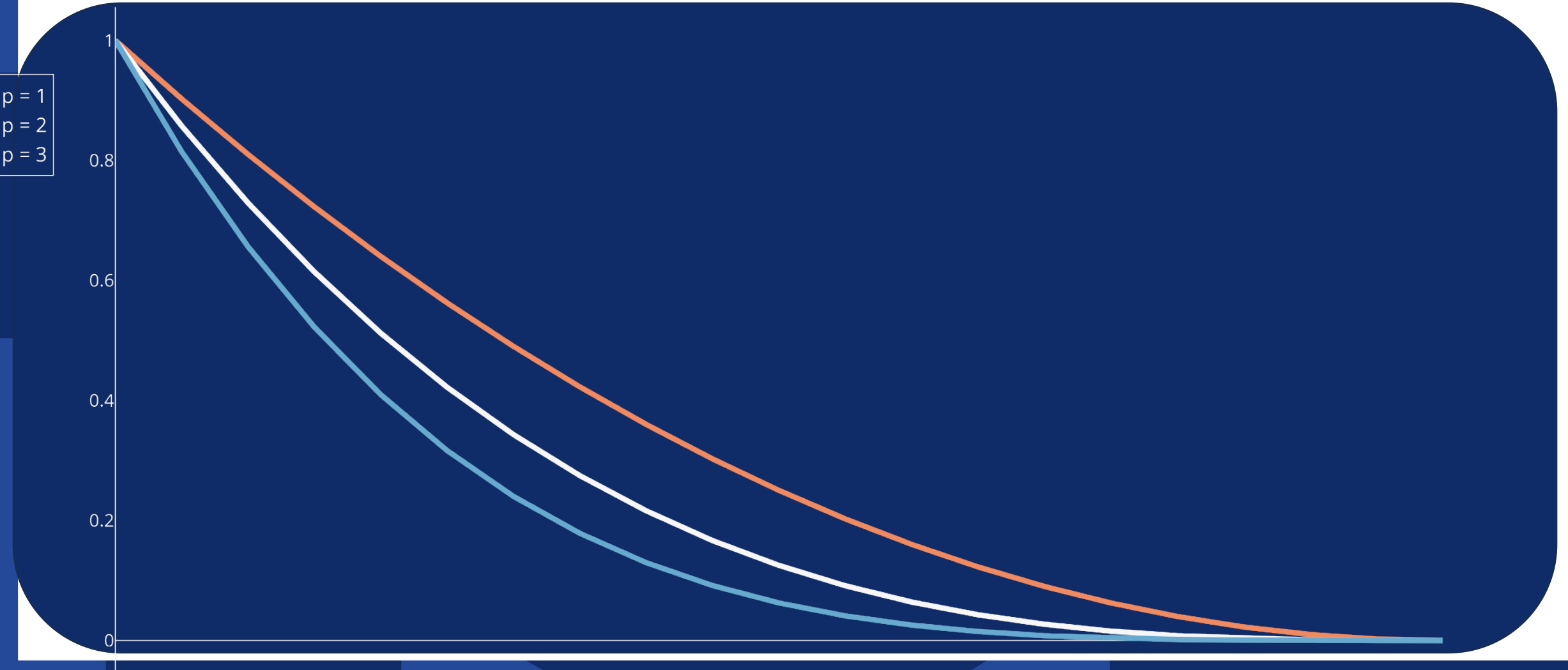
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2



Prioritizing category

Виды штрафующей функции





Prioritizing category

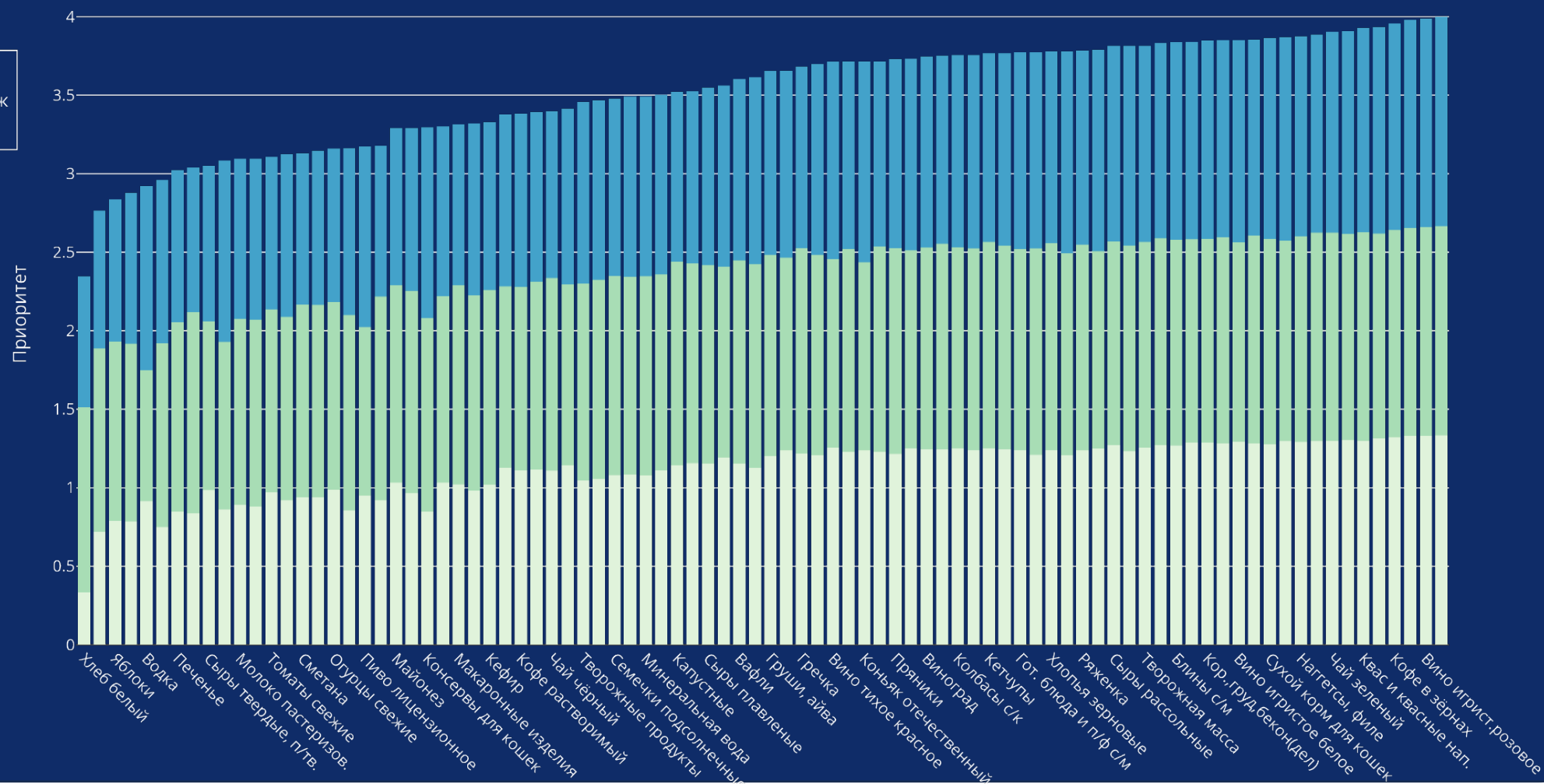
For each category of goods is calculated features:

1. Share of receipts
2. Share in sales volume
3. Customer share

Based on them, the priority of the $p \in$ category is determined [1;3]



Prioritizing category





The algorithm for determining the optimal threshold



No	Goods	Algortihm	Expert
1	BALTIKA STRONG beer No. 9 St.w/w 8% 0.45l	KVI	KVI
2	Beer BALTIKA EXP No. 7 St W/b 5,4% 0.45 l	KVI	KVI
3	ZHIGULI BAR beer St.phil.4,9% w/0.5l	KVI	KVI
4	Beer RED PRICE IS LIGHT.4.1% of PET 1.5 l	KVI	
5	ZHIGULI BAR beer St.phil.4,9% 0.5l	BB	KVI
8	Beer BALTIKA EXP No. 7 St W/b 5,4% 0.45 l	BB	KVI
11	OKHOTA STRONG beer St.8,1% PET 1.4L	BB	KVI
64	ZHIGULI BAR beer St.phil.4,9% 0.5l	BB	KVI

1. Find the point of maximum curvature of the graph
2. KVI left, right, Back Basket



Results

- Уровень конкуренции
- Доля покупателей
- Доля в объеме продаж
- Входимость в чек

Beer



No	Goods	Algortihm	Expert
1	BALTICA STRONG beer No. 9 St.w/w 8% 0.45l	KVI	KVI
2	Beer BALTICA EXP No. 7 St W/b 5,4% 0.45 l	KVI	KVI
3	ZHIGULI BAR beer St.phil.4,9% w/0.5l	KVI	KVI
4	Beer RED PRICE IS LIGHT.4.1% of PET 1.5 l	KVI	
5	ZHIGULI BAR beer St.phil.4,9% 0.5l	BB	KVI
8	Beer BALTICA EXP No. 7 St W/b 5,4% 0.45 l	BB	KVI
11	OKHOTA STRONG beer St.8,1% PET 1.4L	BB	KVI
64	ZHIGULI BAR beer St.phil.4,9% 0.5l	BB	KVI

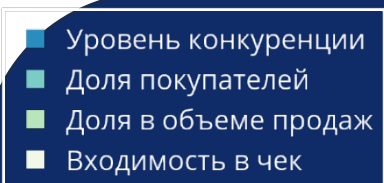


Results

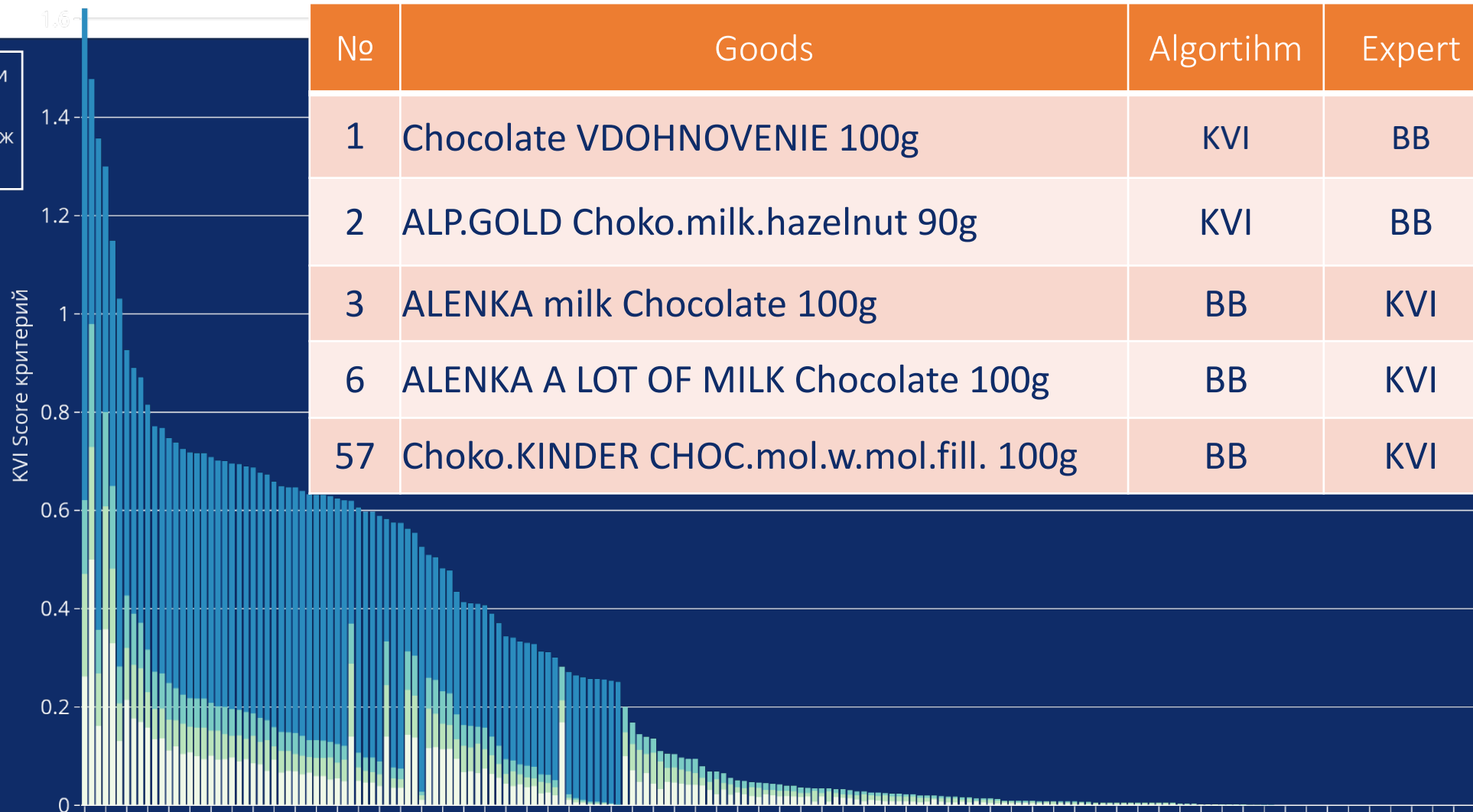




Results



Chocolate tile



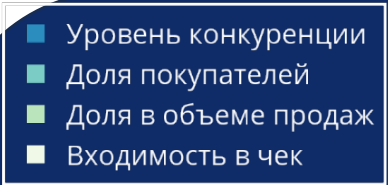


Results

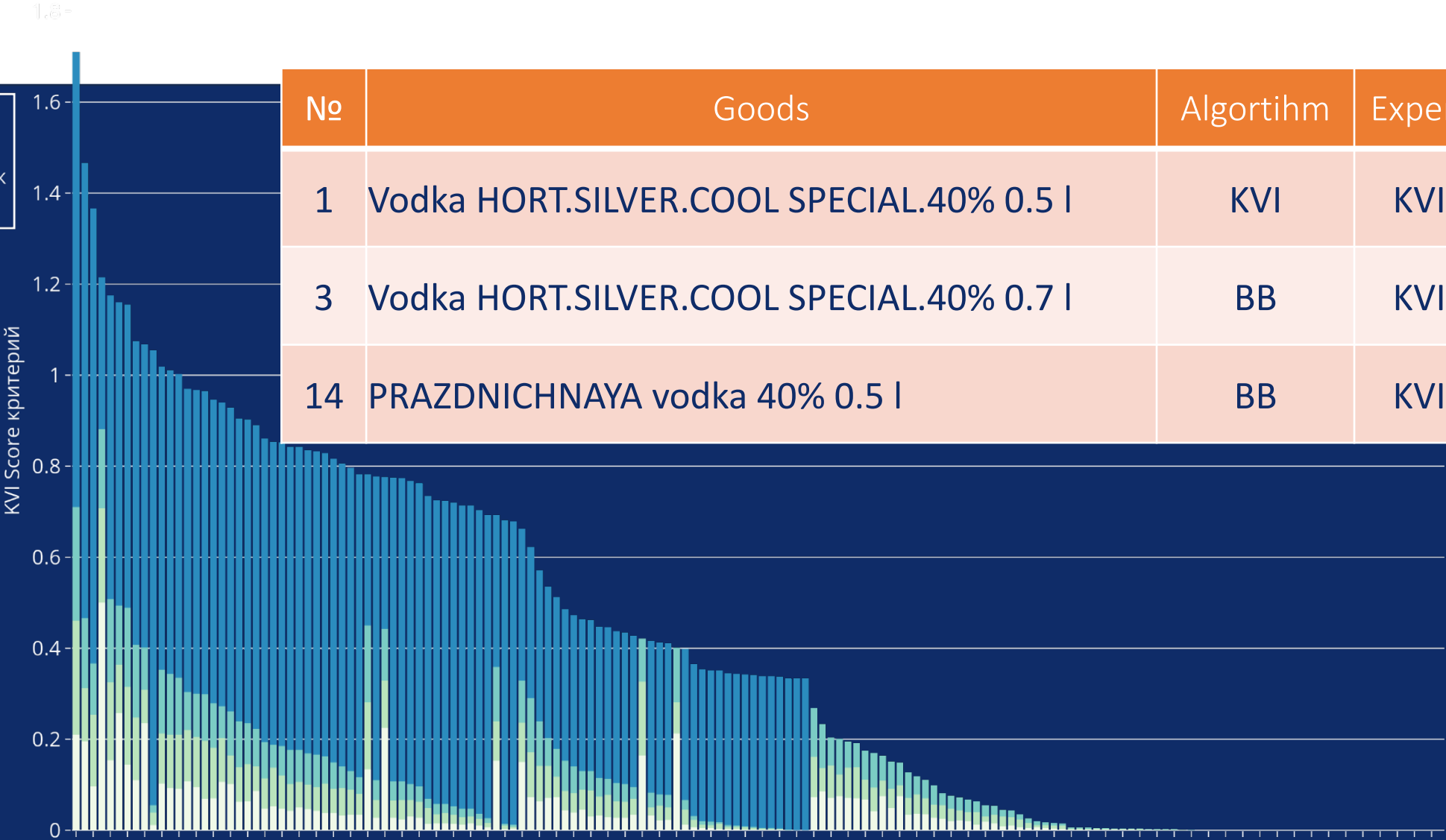


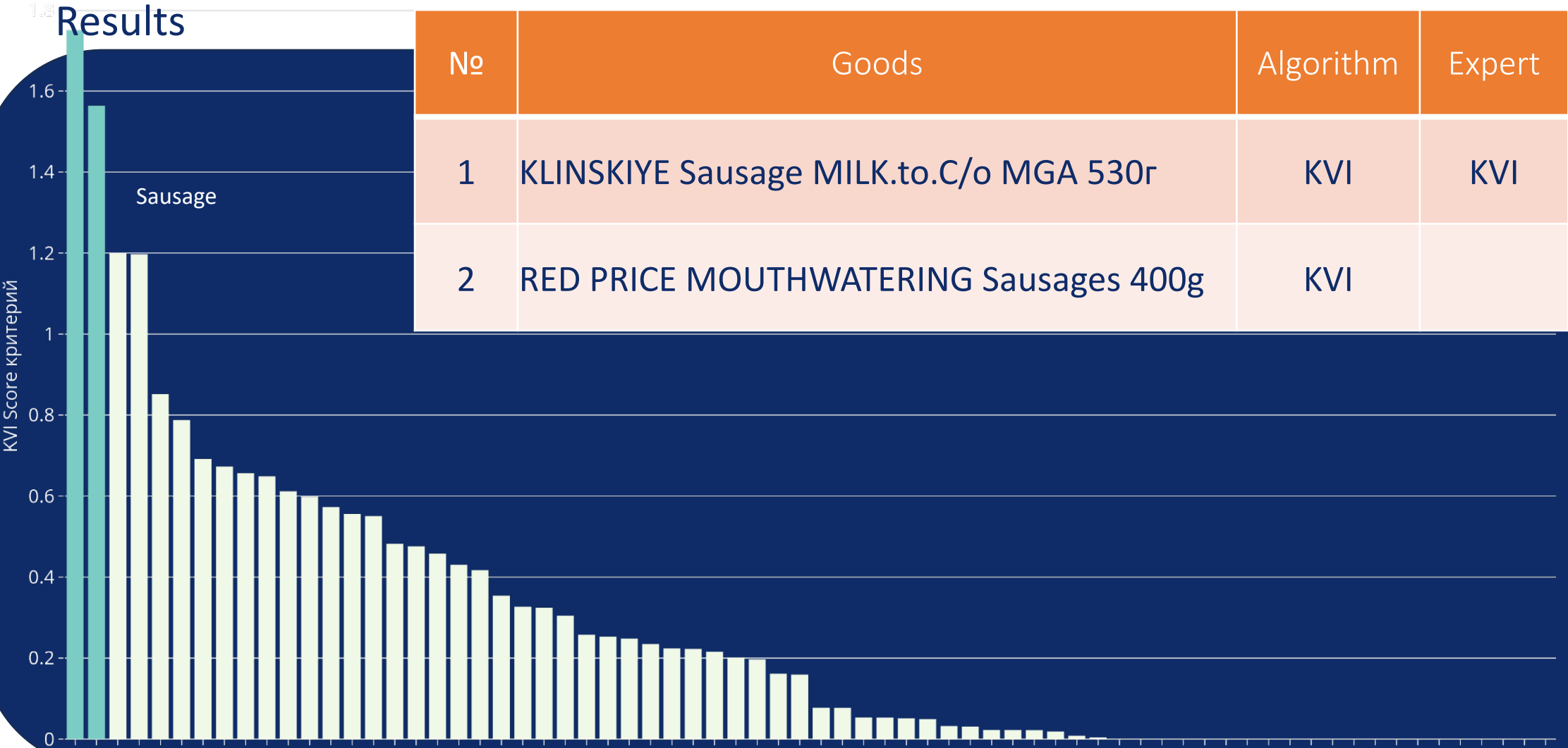


Results



Vodka



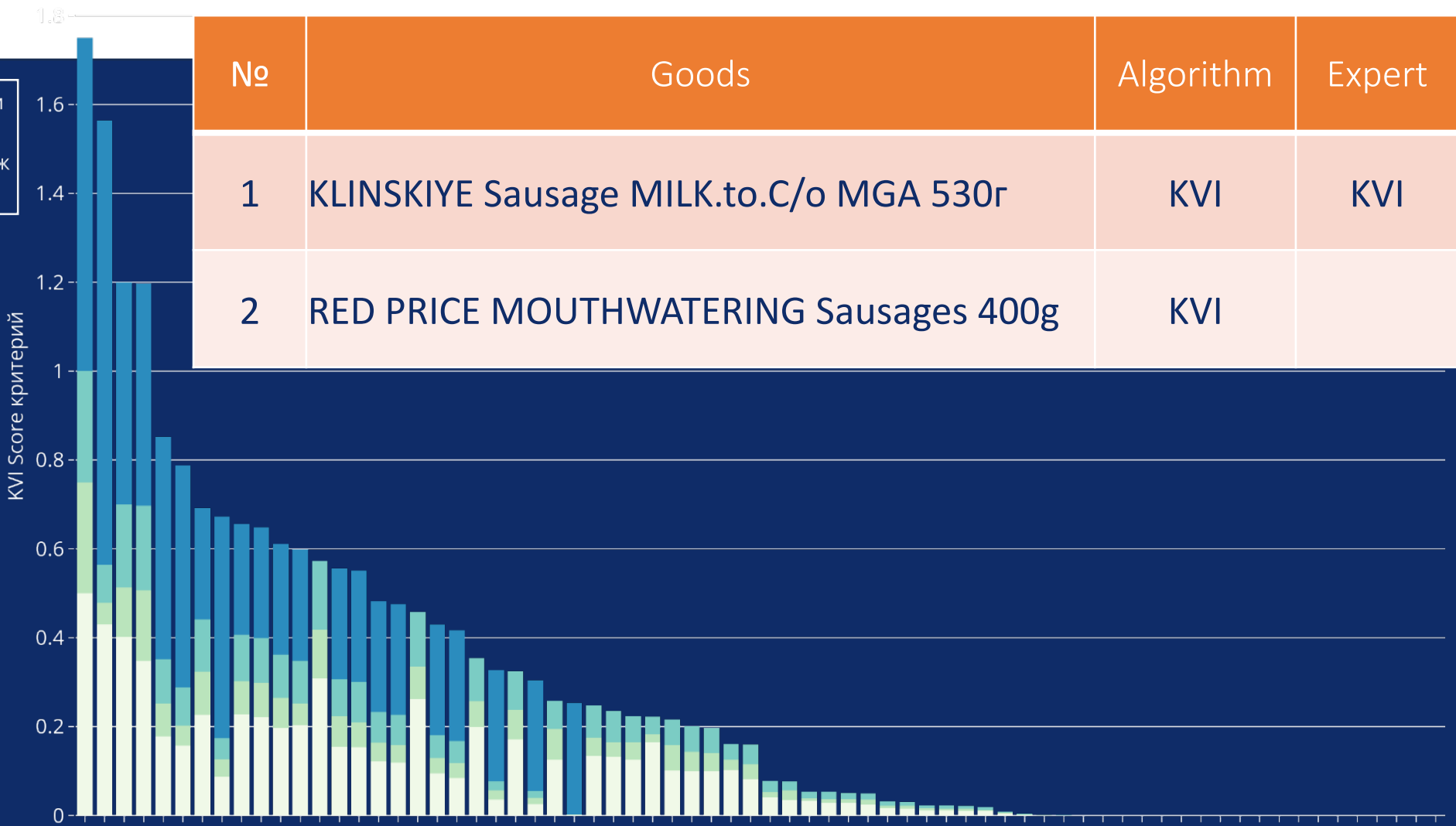




Results

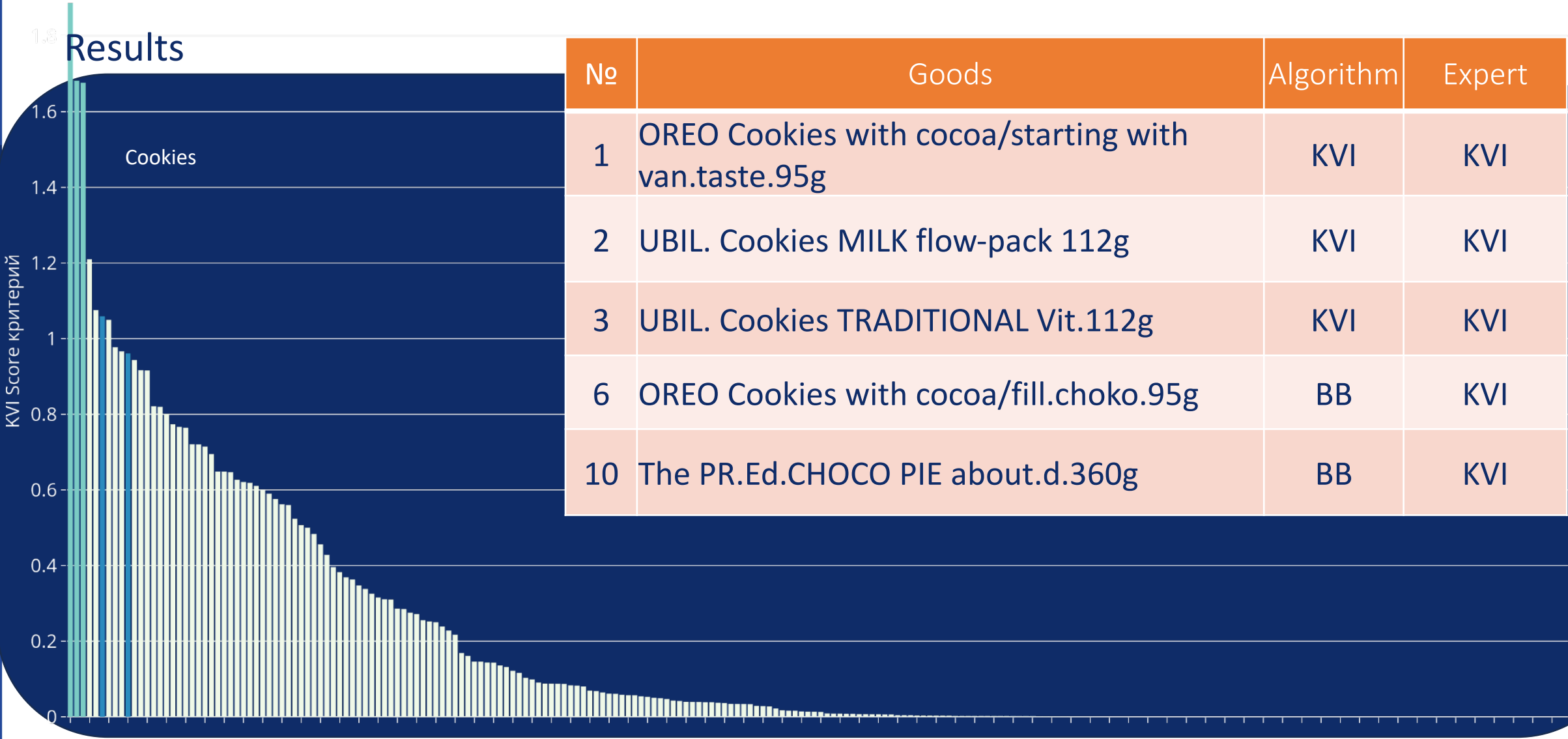
- Уровень конкуренции
- Доля покупателей
- Доля в объеме продаж
- Входимость в чек

Sausage





Results

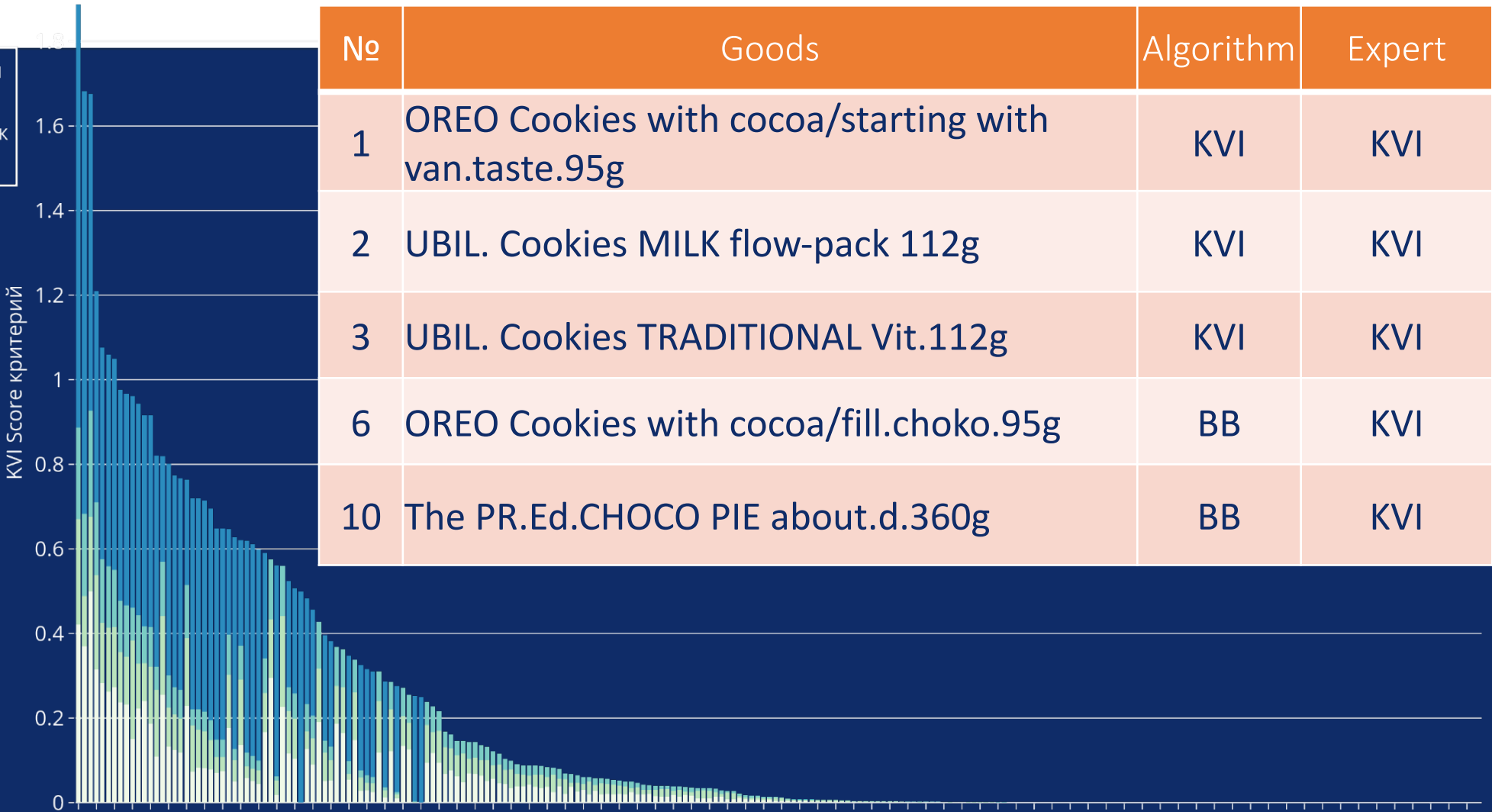




Results

- Уровень конкуренции
- Доля покупателей
- Доля в объеме продаж
- Входимость в чек

Cookies





Results

Instant coffee

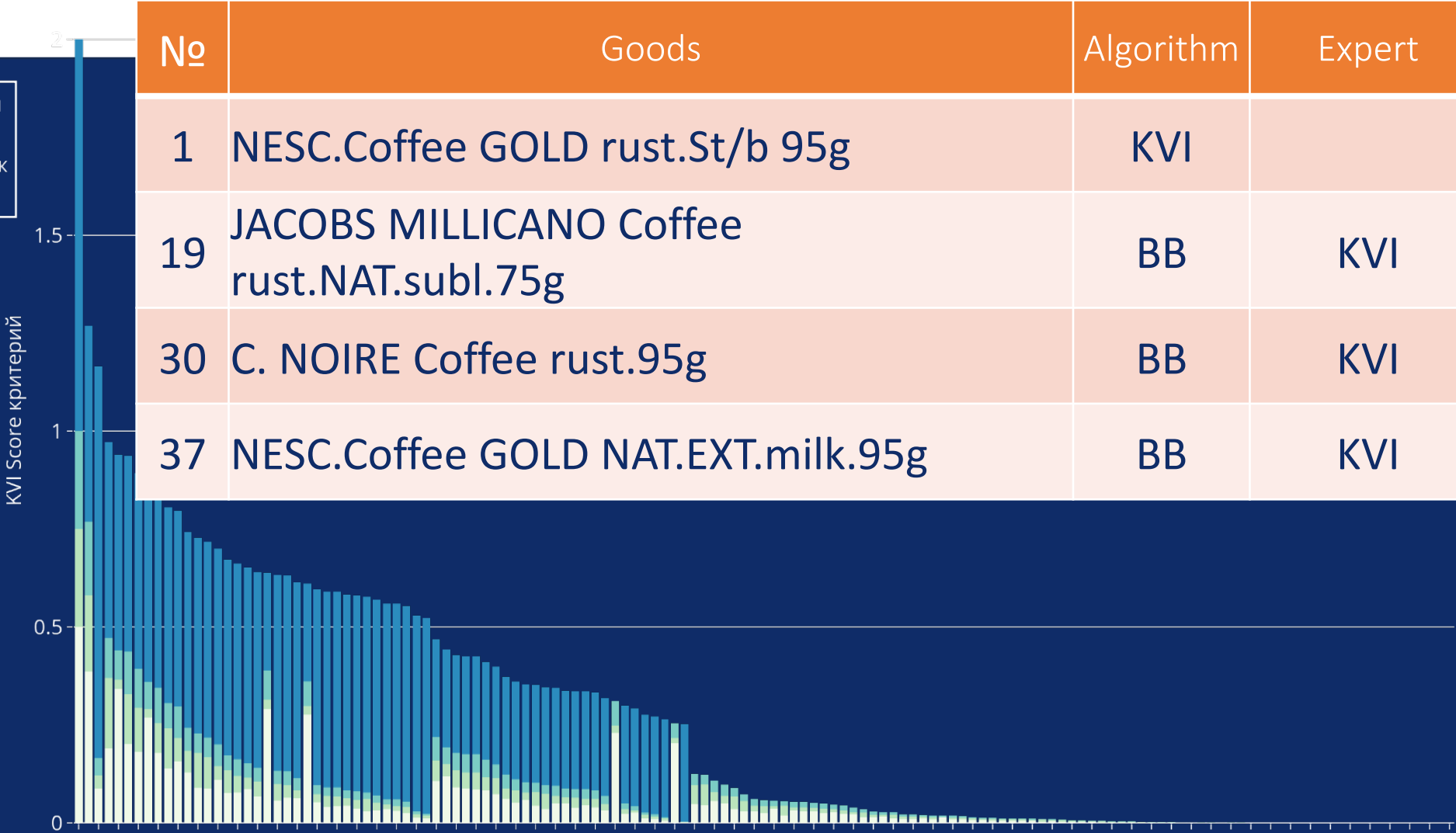
No	Goods	Algorithm	Expert
1	NESC.Coffee GOLD rust.St/b 95g	KVI	
19	JACOBS MILLICANO Coffee rust.NAT.subl.75g	BB	KVI
30	C. NOIRE Coffee rust.95g	BB	KVI
37	NESC.Coffee GOLD NAT.EXT.milk.95g	BB	KVI



Results

- Уровень конкуренции
- Доля покупателей
- Доля в объеме продаж
- Входимость в чек

Instant coffee





Problematic categories

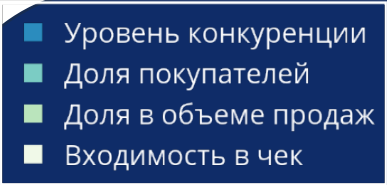
After determining the optimal threshold partitioning is checked: "KVI products < 10% of the number of items in a category".

If the algorithm has identified > 10%, this category falls within the report.

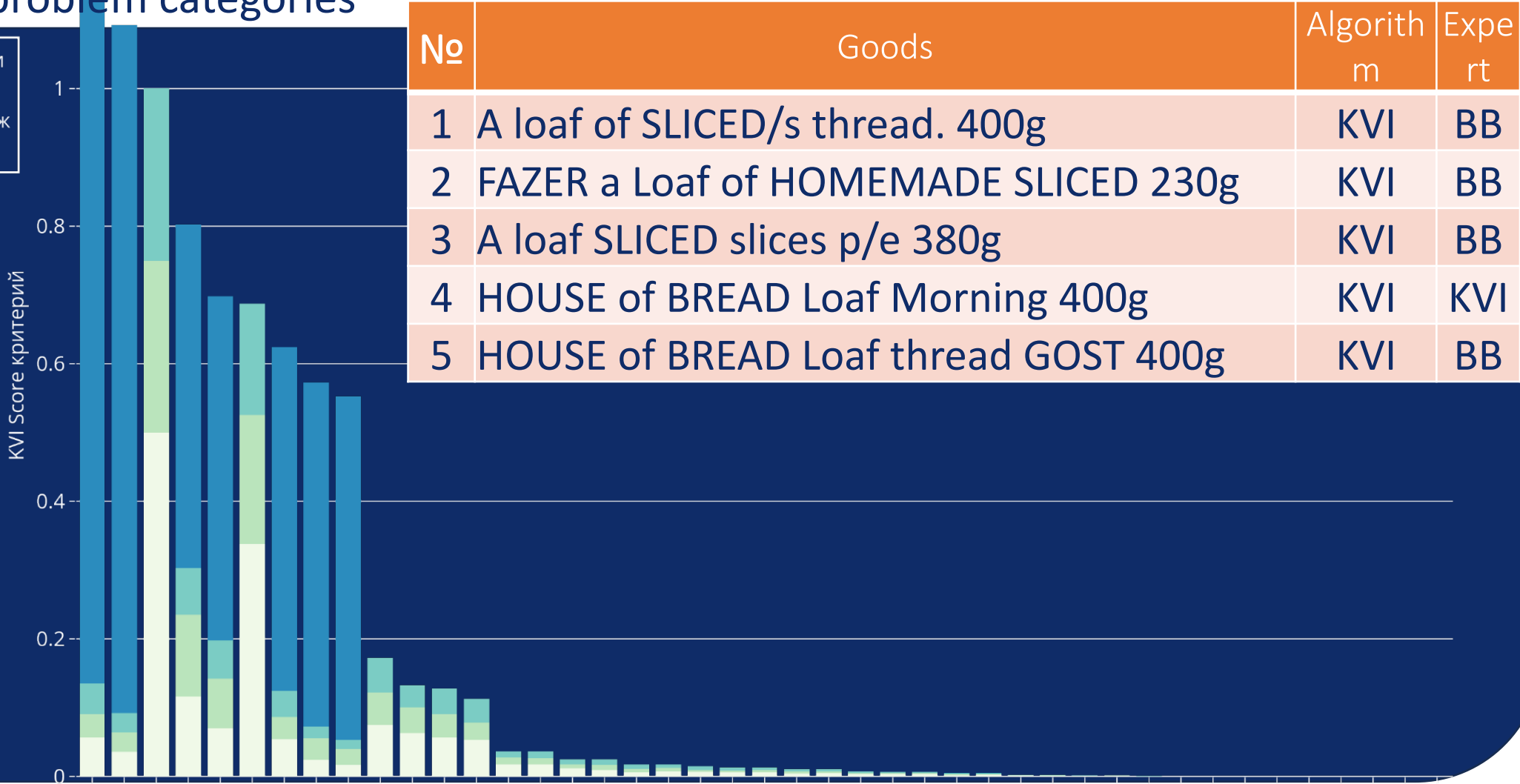
Category	Algorithm	Expert
Crab. Sticks, meat	2	2
Ice cream portions	9	3
Fresh Cucumbers	2	1
Spaghetti	2	2
White bread	5	1



Example of problem categories

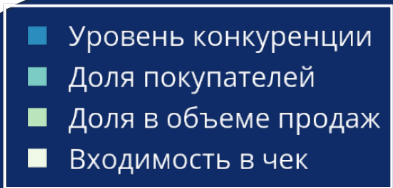


White bread

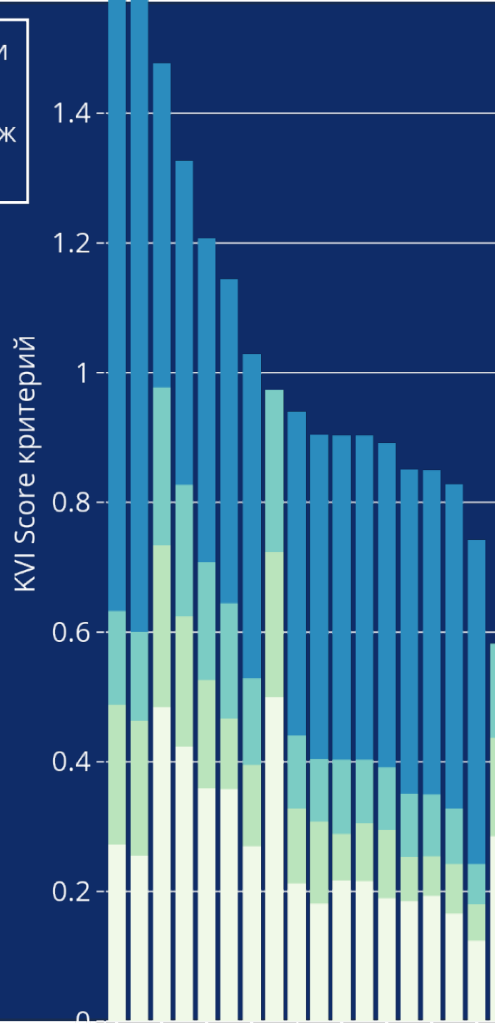




Example of problem categories



Ice cream portion



No	Goods	Algorithm	Expert
1	CHISTAYA LINIYA IC.RUS.ESK.NAT 80gr	KVI	BB
2	CHISTAYA LINIYA .IC MOS.DES.NAT.12% 80gr	KVI	BB
3	KOROVKA.IC.NAT.WAF.CON15%100gr	KVI	KVI
4	KOROVKA.IC.ШОК.NAT. WAF/CON 100gr	KVI	KVI
5	KOROVKA.IC.Creme Brulee.NAT.WAF/CON 100gr	KVI	KVI
6	FIL.ICE CREAM SHERBET BERRY.CON.80gr	KVI	BB
7	VOLOGOD.NAT.IC.NAT.WAF.CON15% 100gr	KVI	BB
8	IC.FIL.LAKOMKA NAT Choko/glaz.90gr	KVI	BB
9	CHISTAYA LINIYA.IC.NAT.CHOKO.inWAF/CO 12%80gr	KVI	BB



Agenda

- Forecast Accuracy Measurement
- Store Clusterization in Retail
- Building KVI products
- HW #3
 - Demand Forecasting





InClass Prediction Competition

Demand Forecasting in Retail

Create Demand Forecast for Retail data

Contest: <https://www.kaggle.com/competitions/dscs-winter24-hw3/host>

Forecast Horizon: 4 weeks ahead

Scope: 3 years of data, ~ 1000 ts

Evaluation criteria:

- punched (better than) **benchmark2** – evaluation 6 to 8
- - punched (better than) **benchmark1** – score 8 to 10
- **Starting code:** https://github.com/aromanenko/ATSF/blob/wip/hw3_solution_example.ipynb



Sum Up

The choice of a metric for measuring the accuracy of forecasts can seriously affect the forecast result.

Forecastability Index (Classification of Demand Forecasting Units to Forecastability Groups) helps to monitor forecast accuracy

The statement and solution of the clustering problem vary greatly depending on the purpose of applying its results.



Self Check Questions

Provide business advantages and disadvantages of WAPE and WAPPE error metrics

Give at least 3 examples of environmental conditions that could change the accuracy value of the demand forecast

Please provide at least two business problems in Retail that use the results of store clusterization?

